

Prime-power congruences for level-one eigenforms

Nadim Rustom*

September 14, 2026

Abstract

We study prime-power congruences for the prime-to- p Hecke eigensystems of normalized cuspidal level-one eigenforms as the weight varies, and we address the problem of classifying such systems for small prime powers. We construct Hecke-equivariant transfer maps between level-one modular-symbol modules via multiplication by suitable lifts of Dickson invariants; these maps reduce the problem to finite computation and propagate Hecke operator relations through all weights. For $p = 2, 3, 5, 7$, we obtain all-weight classifications modulo 2^8 , 3^4 , 5^3 , and 7^2 , respectively.

Contents

I	General theory	3
1	Introduction and main results	3
1.1	The problem	3
1.2	Congruence conventions	5
1.3	Cyclotomic Hecke eigensystems	6
1.4	Main results	7
2	Modular forms and Hecke algebras	10
2.1	Hecke eigensystems, coefficient quotients, and completed Hecke algebras . .	10
2.2	Lifting shallow Hecke generators	11
2.2.1	$p = 2, 3$	12
2.2.2	$p = 5$	13
2.2.3	$p = 7$	14
2.3	Weak realization of cyclotomic packets	15

*rustom.nadim@proton.me
Independent Researcher

3	Modular symbols of level 1	17
3.1	Modular symbols with coefficients in R	17
3.2	Hecke operators	18
3.3	Comparison with modular forms	18
3.4	Dickson multipliers	19
3.5	Transfer map for modular symbols	21
3.6	For odd p	23
3.7	Propagation of Hecke operator relations	24
3.8	Calculus of linear relations	26
3.9	Propagation of divided Hecke relations	31
3.10	Recursive computation of Manin quotients and ideal images	32
II	Computations and classifications	35
4	The prime 2: classification modulo 256	35
4.1	Certified Hecke operator identities	35
4.2	Congruences for a_3 and a_5	37
4.3	Final classification	37
5	The prime 3: classification modulo 81	38
5.1	Certified Hecke operator identities	38
5.1.1	The common T_7 relation	38
5.1.2	The nonzero branch	39
5.1.3	The zero branch	39
5.2	Congruences for a_2 and a_7	41
5.2.1	Congruence for a_7	41
5.2.2	The nonzero branch	42
5.2.3	The zero branch	42
5.3	Final classification	43
6	The prime 5: classification modulo 125	45
6.1	Certified Hecke operator identities	45
6.2	Congruences for a_2 and a_{19}	48
6.3	Final classification	50
7	The prime 7: classification modulo 49	51
7.1	Certified Hecke operator identities	51
7.2	Congruences for a_3 and a_{29}	54
7.3	Final classification	58

III Applications	59
8 Strong prime-to- p weight bounds	59
A Signatures modulo 81	62
B Signatures modulo 49	63

Part I

General theory

1 Introduction and main results

1.1 The problem

In this work, we study congruences modulo prime powers between systems of Hecke eigenvalues arising from normalized cuspidal eigenforms of level 1. We will use the adjective *strong*, following [CKW13, KRW16], to refer to either eigenforms in characteristic 0, or Hecke eigensystems arising from such eigenforms. More precisely, for a fixed prime power p^m , we ask which strong prime-to- p Hecke eigensystems can occur in level 1 as the weight varies, and we seek an explicit classification of these systems.

Questions of this kind belong to the general study of modular forms and Galois representations modulo prime powers. For fixed level N , prime $p \nmid N$, and integer $m \geq 1$, the author, in joint work with Kiming and Wiese, formulated the following finiteness conjecture [KRW16, Conjecture 1].

Conjecture 1.1. There are only finitely many modulo p^m congruence classes of strong Hecke eigenforms on $\Gamma_1(N)$.

Equivalently, there should exist a constant $B(N, p, m)$, called a *strong weight bound*, such that every normalized characteristic-zero eigenform f on $\Gamma_1(N)$ is congruent modulo p^m to a normalized eigenform g on $\Gamma_1(N)$ of weight at most $B(N, p, m)$. A corresponding finiteness statement in characteristic p is known: for fixed level, only finitely many systems of Hecke eigenvalues with values in $\overline{\mathbf{F}}_p$ occur as the weight varies [Joc82].

The case of level 1 already exhibits much of the subtlety of the general problem. Classical results of Hatada [Hat77a, Hat77b, Hat79, Hat81] established a series of striking congruences for Hecke eigenvalues. However, these results generally concern individual Hecke eigenvalues and do not determine whole eigensystems. We record a few representative examples. For every normalized level-one eigenform f , Hatada proved, among other congruences,

$$a_\ell(f) \equiv 1 + \ell \pmod{2^4 \overline{\mathbf{Z}}_2} \quad (\ell \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{2^3}),$$

and

$$a_\ell(f) \equiv 1 + \ell \pmod{2^5 \overline{\mathbf{Z}}_2} \quad (\ell \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{2^4})$$

[Hat79, Hat81].

Coleman and Stein [CS04, Conjecture 3.4] conjectured that exactly five systems of Hecke eigenvalues modulo 3^2 occur in levels 1, 3, and 9, all first occurring at level 1, and gave computational evidence for this conjecture.

Calegari and Emerton subsequently introduced a cohomological approach which allowed them to reprove and extend several of Hatada’s congruences [CE04, Theorem 2.2 and Lemmas 3.1–3.3].

For $p = 7$, Hatada had recorded a conjecture of Serre predicting

$$a_\ell(f) \equiv 1 + \ell \pmod{7\overline{\mathbf{Z}}_7} \quad (\ell \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{7}). \quad (1.1)$$

Calegari and Emerton proved the weaker congruence

$$a_\ell(f) \equiv 1 + \ell \pmod{7^{1/2}\overline{\mathbf{Z}}_7} \quad (\ell \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{7})$$

[CE04, Lemma 3.2]. They also proved, for $p = 3$,

$$a_\ell(f) \equiv 1 + \ell \pmod{3^2\overline{\mathbf{Z}}_3} \quad (\ell \equiv \pm 1 \pmod{3^2}),$$

for every normalized level-one eigenform f [CE04, Lemma 3.3].

In [Rus19], the author obtained a stronger result at level 1. For $p = 2$, all systems of Hecke eigenvalues modulo 2^7 were determined; in particular, for every normalized level-one eigenform f of weight k and every odd prime ℓ ,

$$a_\ell(f) \equiv 1 + \ell^{k-1} \pmod{2^7\overline{\mathbf{Z}}_2}.$$

This gave further evidence for Conjecture 1.1.

There is also a methodological continuity between these works. Calegari and Emerton point out that modular symbols are particularly well adapted to proving congruences that are independent of the weight, and interpret Hatada’s calculations in this framework [CE04]. Their approach gives a cohomological formulation of the same general idea. The method of [Rus19] was also in this spirit, using Merel’s explicit theory of modular symbols to obtain finite computations from which congruences could be deduced. Related use of Dickson invariants in the study of torsion in the cohomology of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbf{Z})$ appears in work of Deng [Den23], who also derives congruences between individual level-one cuspforms and Eisenstein series. His general congruence result is modulo a prime, with some higher prime-power congruences treated in specific examples.

The present work continues this approach and develops it further. In particular, we are able to prove the level 1 cases of Serre’s conjecture (1.1) and Coleman-Stein’s conjecture [CS04, Conjecture 3.4]. The main new ingredient is a family of Hecke-equivariant transfer maps entirely within level 1, obtained by multiplication by suitable lifts of Dickson invariants. These maps propagate relations between level-one modular-symbol modules of different degrees and thereby reduce all-weight congruence questions to finite computation. In this way, we first obtain congruences for selected Hecke eigenvalues. Then we show that the Hecke operators to which these eigenvalues correspond generate the completed p -adic Hecke algebra, so that these congruences are enough to control every other Hecke eigenvalue. We do this by lifting Medvedovsky’s [Med15] explicitly determined generators of the corresponding mod p Hecke algebras.

In this sense, the methods used here may be viewed as a more systematic development of the ideas introduced in [Rus19]. We do not claim that the results obtained here are the limits of what one could prove using this method: the necessary computations were run on

the author's modest laptop, and we believe that more can be achieved on a more powerful machine.

In the GitHub repository [Rus26], we provide Python/SageMath code, interfacing with PARI/GP, which can be used to run and verify the computational work needed for the results of this paper. We also provide an alternative backend, written in Nim and interfacing with FLINT, which computes the needed spaces of modular symbols and the actions of the Hecke operators. The two routes are theoretically identical, but the Nim code is much faster, and can be used to verify the computationally heavy case of mod 7^2 classification. For each of our main theorems, we present the verification through Jupyter notebooks which can be run on a Sage server.

In the next few introductory subsections, we fix notation and state the main results of the paper.

Acknowledgements and AI use disclosure. The core of this work was developed by the author while employed as Assistant Professor at Koç University, Istanbul, during 2018–2020. In particular, the level 1 Coleman-Stein conjecture, and the level 1 Serre conjecture modulo $7^{3/4}\mathbf{Z}_7$, were obtained at that time.

AI tools, in particular Codex/GPT-5.6 Sol, were used to extend these initial results. AI contributions consisted mainly in the identification of the conjectural classifications and weight bounds in each case. AI also contributed significantly to the search for the modular-symbol Hecke operator identities used in Part II to obtain congruences for selected Hecke eigenvalues. As the working modulus increases, these identities become increasingly complicated, and AI was useful for rapidly testing, rejecting, and identifying plausible identities.

All AI-generated code was reviewed, and all computational results obtained were subsequently verified independently by the author. AI was also used for proofreading the manuscript, correcting typographical errors, and identifying notational inconsistencies. AI was not involved in the development of the theoretical ideas in this work. The author takes full responsibility for all mathematical statements, proofs, computations, and references in the final manuscript.

1.2 Congruence conventions

Let p be a prime number, and fix once and for all algebraic closures $\overline{\mathbf{Q}}$, with ring of integers $\overline{\mathbf{Z}}$, and $\overline{\mathbf{Q}}_p$, with ring of integers $\overline{\mathbf{Z}}_p$, together with an embedding

$$\overline{\mathbf{Q}} \hookrightarrow \overline{\mathbf{Q}}_p.$$

Let v_p denote the normalized valuation on $\overline{\mathbf{Q}}_p$, so that $v_p(p) = 1$.

We first clarify what we mean by congruence modulo p^m , since two different notions arise when the coefficient field is ramified.

Definition 1.2. Let $\mathcal{O}$ be the ring of integers of a finite extension of $\mathbf{Q}_p$, let π be a uniformizer, and let $e_{\mathcal{O}}$ be the ramification index, so that $p\mathcal{O} = \pi^{e_{\mathcal{O}}}\mathcal{O}$. For $m \geq 1$ and $x, y \in \mathcal{O}$, define

$$\begin{aligned} x \equiv_{\text{val}} y \pmod{p^m} &\iff v_p(x - y) > m - 1, \\ x \equiv_{\text{lit}} y \pmod{p^m} &\iff x - y \in p^m\mathcal{O}. \end{aligned}$$

We call the first a *valuative congruence modulo p^m* and the second a *literal congruence modulo p^m* . The valutive convention is the one used in [KRW16, §1.1, pp. 479–480].

Equivalently, valutive congruence modulo p^m is equality in $\mathcal{O}/\pi^{e_{\mathcal{O}}(m-1)+1}\mathcal{O}$, whereas literal congruence modulo p^m is equality in $\mathcal{O}/p^m\mathcal{O} = \mathcal{O}/\pi^{me_{\mathcal{O}}}\mathcal{O}$. If the coefficient field is unramified, the two notions agree. If $e_{\mathcal{O}} > 1$, literal congruence is stronger. More generally, literal congruence modulo p^m implies valutive congruence modulo p^m , while valutive congruence modulo p^{m+1} implies literal congruence modulo p^m . Indeed,

$$\pi^{e_{\mathcal{O}}m+1}\mathcal{O} \subseteq \pi^{me_{\mathcal{O}}}\mathcal{O} \subseteq \pi^{e_{\mathcal{O}}(m-1)+1}\mathcal{O}.$$

For modular forms, congruence is understood coefficientwise. Thus, if

$$f = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_n(f)q^n, \quad g = \sum_{n \geq 0} a_n(g)q^n$$

have coefficients in $\mathcal{O}$, we write

$$f \equiv g \pmod{p^m}$$

valuatively, respectively literally, if

$$a_n(f) \equiv a_n(g) \pmod{p^m} \quad (n \geq 0)$$

in the valutive, respectively literal, sense. The Fourier coefficients of a normalized Hecke eigenform f (normalized meaning that $a_1(f) = 1$) are algebraic integers; hence, under our fixed embedding

$$\overline{\mathbf{Q}} \hookrightarrow \overline{\mathbf{Q}}_p,$$

they belong to $\overline{\mathbf{Z}}_p$. If f and g are normalized Hecke eigenforms, we say that their *prime-to- p Hecke eigensystems* are congruent modulo p^m , valutively or literally, if

$$a_n(f) \equiv a_n(g) \pmod{p^m} \quad ((n, p) = 1)$$

in the corresponding sense. Such congruences may be checked in the ring of integers of any finite extension of $\mathbf{Q}_p$ containing the coefficients of both forms.

1.3 Cyclotomic Hecke eigensystems

Let φ denote the Euler totient function, and put $\theta := q \frac{d}{dq}$. For even $\kappa \geq 4$, let

$$G_{\kappa} := -\frac{B_{\kappa}}{2\kappa} + \sum_{n \geq 1} \sigma_{\kappa-1}(n)q^n, \quad \sigma_{\kappa-1}(n) := \sum_{d|n} d^{\kappa-1},$$

be the Eisenstein series normalized at the first degree term. For $i \geq 1$, the constant term is killed by θ^i , and

$$\theta^i G_{\kappa} = \sum_{n \geq 1} n^i \sigma_{\kappa-1}(n)q^n$$

has integral coefficients.

Definition 1.3 (Cyclotomic Hecke eigensystem). Let f be a normalized Hecke eigenform. Its prime-to- p Hecke eigensystem is called *cyclotomic modulo p^m* if, for some integer $i \geq m$ and some even integer $\kappa \geq 4$,

$$a_n(f) \equiv n^i \sigma_{\kappa-1}(n) \pmod{p^m} \quad ((n, p) = 1).$$

The congruence may be understood literally or valutively, as in Definition 1.2.

If $e \geq m$ is divisible by the exponent of $(\mathbf{Z}/p^m\mathbf{Z})^\times$, this condition is equivalent to

$$\theta^e f \equiv \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{p^m}$$

in the same sense. At primes $\ell \neq p$, it gives

$$a_\ell(f) \equiv \ell^i + \ell^{i+\kappa-1} \pmod{p^m}.$$

By symmetry of the divisor sum, the prime-to- p coefficient system depends only on the unordered pair $\{i, i + \kappa - 1\}$, with exponents taken modulo the exponent of $(\mathbf{Z}/p^m\mathbf{Z})^\times$. We also refer to this system as a cyclotomic packet.

1.4 Main results

We now state the main results of the paper. Throughout this subsection, let f be a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform of even weight k , and let $\mathcal{O}_f$ be the ring of integers of a finite extension of $\mathbf{Q}_p$ containing the coefficients of f .

Theorem 1.4 (Prime-to-2 classification modulo 256). *If*

$$k - 2 \equiv 2, 4, 10, 12 \pmod{16},$$

then

$$\theta^{64} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^{64} G_k \pmod{256}.$$

If

$$k - 2 \equiv 0, 6, 8, 14 \pmod{16},$$

then exactly one of

$$\theta^{64} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^{64} G_k \pmod{256}$$

and

$$\theta^{64} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^{16} G_{k+32} \pmod{256}$$

holds.

Writing the selected Eisenstein twist as $\theta^i G_\kappa$, the unordered pair

$$\{a, b\} := \{i, i + \kappa - 1\} \subset \mathbf{Z}/64\mathbf{Z}$$

is uniquely determined by f . Its possibilities are:

$k \bmod 16$	$\{a, b\}$
0, 2, 8, 10	$\{0, k - 1\}, \{16, k - 17\}$
4, 6, 12, 14	$\{0, k - 1\}$.

Conversely, for every even residue class $k_0 \bmod 64$, each permitted prime-to-2 Hecke eigen-system is realized by a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform of some weight $K \equiv k_0 \pmod{64}$. Thus there are exactly 48 strong prime-to-2 Hecke eigensystems modulo 256, in the valuative sense.

Theorem 1.5 (Prime-to-3 classification modulo 81). *There exist integers $i \geq 4$ and even $\kappa \geq 4$, with $\kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{54}$, and a modular form δ_f over $\mathbf{F}_9$, such that*

$$\theta^{54} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^i G_\kappa + 27\delta_f \pmod{81}.$$

In particular,

$$\theta^{54}f \equiv_{\text{lit}} \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{27}.$$

The unordered pair

$$\{a, b\} := \{i, i + \kappa - 1\} \subset \mathbf{Z}/18\mathbf{Z}$$

is uniquely determined by f and belongs to the following list:

$k \bmod 18$	$\{a, b\}$
0	$\{0, 17\}, \{8, 9\}$
2	$\{0, 1\}, \{9, 10\}$
4	$\{0, 3\}, \{6, 15\}, \{9, 12\}$
6	$\{0, 5\}, \{9, 14\}$
8	$\{0, 7\}, \{9, 16\}$
10	$\{0, 9\}, \{3, 6\}, \{12, 15\}$
12	$\{0, 11\}, \{2, 9\}$
14	$\{0, 13\}, \{4, 9\}$
16	$\{0, 15\}, \{3, 12\}, \{6, 9\}.$

There exists a unique value $\alpha \in \mathbf{Z}_3[\sqrt{2}]$ listed for $k \bmod 54$ in Table 3 of Appendix A, such that

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} \alpha \pmod{81}, \quad a_7(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 1 + 7^{k-1} \pmod{81}.$$

Once i, κ are fixed, the signature $(k \bmod 54, \alpha)$ determines the q -expansion of δ_f . The correction δ_f is defined over $\mathbf{F}_3$ when α is rational, and over $\mathbf{F}_9$, but not over $\mathbf{F}_3$, otherwise.

Two normalized cuspidal level-one eigenforms have congruent prime-to-3 Hecke eigensystems modulo 81, in the valuative sense, if and only if their weights are congruent modulo 54 and their corresponding values α agree.

Every signature in Table 3 is realized by a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform of weight at most 214 in the corresponding residue class modulo 54. Thus there are exactly 159 such eigensystems modulo 81. Their reductions realize all 21 pairs listed above, giving exactly 21 strong prime-to-3 Hecke eigensystems modulo 27, in the literal sense.

Theorem 1.5 implies the Coleman-Stein conjecture at level 1.

Theorem 1.6 (Prime-to-5 classification modulo 125). *There exist integers $i \geq 3$ and even $\kappa \geq 4$, with $\kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{100}$, and a modular form δ_f over $\mathbf{F}_5$, such that*

$$\theta^{100}f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^i G_\kappa + 25\delta_f \pmod{125}.$$

In particular,

$$\theta^{100}f \equiv_{\text{lit}} \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{25}.$$

The unordered pair

$$\{a, b\} := \{i, i + \kappa - 1\} \subset \mathbf{Z}/20\mathbf{Z}$$

is uniquely determined by f and belongs to the following list:

$k \bmod 20$	$\{a, b\}$
0	$\{0, 19\}, \{3, 16\}, \{4, 15\}, \{5, 14\}, \{6, 13\}, \{9, 10\}$
2	$\{0, 1\}, \{4, 17\}, \{5, 16\}, \{6, 15\}, \{7, 14\}, \{10, 11\}$
4	$\{0, 3\}, \{4, 19\}, \{5, 18\}, \{8, 15\}, \{9, 14\}, \{10, 13\}$
6	$\{0, 5\}, \{2, 3\}, \{6, 19\}, \{9, 16\}, \{10, 15\}, \{12, 13\}$
8	$\{0, 7\}, \{1, 6\}, \{2, 5\}, \{10, 17\}, \{11, 16\}, \{12, 15\}$
10	$\{0, 9\}, \{1, 8\}, \{4, 5\}, \{10, 19\}, \{11, 18\}, \{14, 15\}$
12	$\{0, 11\}, \{1, 10\}, \{2, 9\}, \{5, 6\}, \{12, 19\}, \{15, 16\}$
14	$\{0, 13\}, \{3, 10\}, \{4, 9\}, \{5, 8\}, \{14, 19\}, \{15, 18\}$
16	$\{0, 15\}, \{1, 14\}, \{4, 11\}, \{5, 10\}, \{7, 8\}, \{17, 18\}$
18	$\{0, 17\}, \{1, 16\}, \{2, 15\}, \{5, 12\}, \{6, 11\}, \{7, 10\}$.

Put $r \equiv k - 2 \pmod{100}$, with $0 \leq r < 100$, and use the constants in Table 1. There exists a unique pair

$$(a, t) \in \mathbf{Z}/125\mathbf{Z} \times \mathbf{Z}/25\mathbf{Z}$$

satisfying

$$t = v_r \quad \text{or} \quad t \equiv v_r \pm 2 \pmod{5},$$

and

$$a^2 \equiv h_{r,0} + 5h_{r,1}t + 25h_{r,2}t^2 \pmod{125},$$

such that

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a \pmod{125}, \quad a_{19}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 5t \pmod{125}.$$

Once i, κ are fixed, the signature $(r, a, 5t)$ determines the q -expansion of δ_f .

Two normalized cuspidal level-one eigenforms have congruent prime-to-5 Hecke eigensystems modulo 125, in the valuative sense, if and only if their weights are congruent modulo 100 and their corresponding pairs (a, t) agree.

Every permitted signature $(r, a, 5t)$ is realized by a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform of weight at most 598 in the corresponding residue class modulo 100. Thus there are exactly 1100 such eigensystems modulo 125. Their reductions realize all 60 pairs listed above, giving exactly 60 strong prime-to-5 Hecke eigensystems modulo 25, in the literal sense.

Theorem 1.7 (Prime-to-7 classification modulo 49). *There exist integers $i \geq 2$ and even $\kappa \geq 4$, with $\kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{42}$, and a modular form δ_f over $\mathbf{F}_7$, such that*

$$\theta^{42}f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^i G_\kappa + 7\delta_f \pmod{49}.$$

In particular,

$$\theta^{42}f \equiv_{\text{lit}} \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{7}.$$

The unordered pair

$$\{a, b\} := \{i, i + \kappa - 1\} \subset \mathbf{Z}/6\mathbf{Z}$$

is uniquely determined by f and belongs to the following list:

$k \bmod 6$	$\{a, b\}$
0	$\{0, 5\}, \{1, 4\}, \{2, 3\}$
2	$\{0, 1\}, \{2, 5\}, \{3, 4\}$
4	$\{0, 3\}, \{1, 2\}, \{4, 5\}$.

There exists a unique triple

$$(c, x, y) \in \{0, \dots, 6\}^3$$

listed for $k \bmod 42$ in Table 4 of Appendix B, such that

$$a_3(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} c + 7x \pmod{49}, \quad a_{29}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 2 + 7y \pmod{49}.$$

Once i, κ are fixed, the signature $(k \bmod 42, c, x, y)$ determines the q -expansion of δ_f .

Two normalized cuspidal level-one eigenforms have congruent prime-to-7 Hecke eigensystems modulo 49, in the valuative sense, if and only if their weights are congruent modulo 42 and their corresponding triples (c, x, y) agree.

Every signature in Table 4 is realized by a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform of weight at most 380 in the corresponding residue class modulo 42. Thus there are exactly 315 such eigensystems modulo 49. Their reductions realize all nine pairs listed above, giving exactly 9 strong prime-to-7 Hecke eigensystems modulo 7, in the literal sense.

Theorem 1.7 implies Serre's conjecture at level 1.

2 Modular forms and Hecke algebras

2.1 Hecke eigensystems, coefficient quotients, and completed Hecke algebras

Denote by $S_k(\mathbf{Z}) \subset \mathbf{Z}[[q]]$ the lattice generated by the q -expansions of level 1 cuspforms of weight k with coefficients in $\mathbf{Z}$. Let K be a finite extension of $\mathbf{Q}_p$ with ring of integers $\mathcal{O}$. We will denote by $S_k(\mathcal{O})$ the $\mathcal{O}$ -submodule of $\mathcal{O}[[q]]$ spanned by the image of $S_k(\mathbf{Z})$.

For $h \geq 0$, put

$$S_{\leq h}(\mathcal{O}) := \sum_{0 \leq k \leq h} S_k(\mathcal{O}), \quad D_{\leq h}(\mathcal{O}) := (S_{\leq h}(\mathcal{O}) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}} K) \cap \mathcal{O}[[q]].$$

Equivalently, $D_{\leq h}(\mathcal{O})$ is the p -power saturation of $S_{\leq h}(\mathcal{O})$ inside $\mathcal{O}[[q]]$. For B a p -adically complete and separated local $\mathcal{O}$ -algebra B , put

$$D_{\leq h}(B) := D_{\leq h}(\mathcal{O}) \otimes_{\mathcal{O}} B$$

and denote by $S_k(B)$ the image of $S_k(\mathcal{O})$ in $D_{\leq h}(B)$. These spaces inherit the action of the Hecke operators from the spaces of modular forms.

We recall the definition of strong, weak, and dc-weak eigenform, first introduced in [CKW13].

Definition 2.1 (Strong, weak, and dc-weak eigenforms). Let B be a finite local $\mathbf{Z}_p$ -algebra and let $f = q + \sum_{n \geq 2} a_n(f)q^n \in B[[q]]$ be a normalized q -expansion with coefficients in B .

1. The form f is *strong* if it is obtained by reducing a normalized characteristic-zero eigenform through a coefficient-ring map to B .
2. The form f is *weak* if $f \in S_k(B)$ for some k and is a simultaneous Hecke eigenform there.
3. The form f is *dc-weak* if $f \in D_{\leq h}(B)$ for some h and is a simultaneous Hecke eigenform there.

Definition 2.2. For each h , define

$$\mathbb{T}_{\leq h}^{(p)}(R) := \text{im}(R[\mathbb{T}_n : (n, p) = 1] \rightarrow \text{End}_R(D_{\leq h}(R))). \quad (2.1)$$

If $h \leq h'$, restriction from $D_{\leq h'}(R)$ to $D_{\leq h}(R)$ allows us to define the completed algebra

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(R) := \varprojlim_h \mathbb{T}_{\leq h}^{(p)}(R). \quad (2.2)$$

We will usually write $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)} := \mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathbf{Z}_p)$.

For $u \in \mathbf{Z}_p^\times$, Katz's weight action $[u]$ on divided congruences acts on weight k by u^k ; see [Kat75a, (2.4)] and [Kat75b, §X]. The extension to the low-level cases $N < 3$ used here is explained in [Rus19, Theorem 2.2 and the following paragraph]. For odd p , put $t_\Lambda := [1 + p]$, and for $p = 2$, put $t_\Lambda := [5]$. It can be shown that $t_\Lambda \in \mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(R)$ [BK15, Lemma 9].

Hecke eigensystems away-from- p arising from strong, weak, or dc-weak eigenforms with coefficients in R correspond to continuous $\mathbf{Z}_p$ -algebra homomorphisms $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)} \rightarrow R$.

Definition 2.3 (Shallow Hecke algebra). Let $M_{\leq h}(\mathbf{F}_p)$ be the space of classical level-one modular forms modulo p of weights at most h . Following the terminology of [BK15, §1.2], define the *shallow Hecke algebra* by

$$\mathbb{T}^{\text{sh},(p)} := \varprojlim_h \text{im}(\mathbf{F}_p[\mathbb{T}_n : (n, p) = 1] \longrightarrow \text{End}_{\mathbf{F}_p}(M_{\leq h}(\mathbf{F}_p))).$$

For a residual prime-to- p eigensystem τ , its completed local factor is denoted $\mathbb{T}_\tau^{\text{sh},(p)}$.

2.2 Lifting shallow Hecke generators

Let $\mathbf{F}/\mathbf{F}_p$ be a finite extension, and put

$$\mathbb{T}_{\mathbf{F}}^{\text{sh},(p)} := \mathbb{T}^{\text{sh},(p)} \otimes_{\mathbf{F}_p} \mathbf{F}.$$

For an $\mathbf{F}$ -valued residual eigensystem

$$\tau : \mathbb{T}_{\mathbf{F}}^{\text{sh},(p)} \longrightarrow \mathbf{F},$$

let

$$\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}} := \ker(\tau),$$

and denote by $\mathbb{T}_\tau^{\text{sh},(p)}$ the corresponding completed local factor.

Let $\mathcal{O}$ be the ring of integers of a finite extension of $\mathbf{Q}_p$ with residue field $\mathbf{F}$, and assume that all residual prime-to- p eigensystems are $\mathbf{F}$ -valued. The Hecke algebra $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O})$ is a complete Noetherian semilocal ring, with decomposition

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O}) = \prod_{\tau} \mathbb{T}_{\text{dc},\tau}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O}),$$

where τ runs over the residual prime-to- p eigensystems.

Lemma 2.4 (Lifting shallow generators). *Assume that $p \geq 5$. Let*

$$\mathcal{H} = \{h_1, \dots, h_s\} \subseteq \mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O}),$$

and write $\bar{h}_i$ for the image of h_i in $\mathbb{T}_{\mathbf{F}}^{\text{sh},(p)}$. Suppose that:

1. for every residual eigensystem τ , the classes of

$$\bar{h}_i - \tau(\bar{h}_i), \quad 1 \leq i \leq s,$$

span

$$\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}} / (\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}})^2;$$

2. the map

$$\tau \longmapsto (\tau(\bar{h}_1), \dots, \tau(\bar{h}_s)) \in \mathbf{F}^s$$

is injective.

Then

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O}) = \overline{\mathcal{O}[t_\Lambda, h_1, \dots, h_s]}.$$

Proof. The passage from generators of

$$\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}} / (\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}})^2$$

to topological generators of the completed local factor $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}, \tau}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O})$, using Nakayama's lemma, is the argument used in [Rus19, §7]. We recall it briefly. By [BK15, Lemma 9], $t_\Lambda = [1 + p]$ belongs to $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O})$, and the argument in the proof of [BK15, Proposition 16] gives, after extension of scalars and passage to the τ -local factor,

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}, \tau}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O}) / (\pi, t_\Lambda - 1) \mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}, \tau}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O}) \simeq \mathbb{T}_\tau^{\text{sh}, (p)}.$$

Hypothesis (1), together with Nakayama's lemma, therefore shows that $t_\Lambda, h_1, \dots, h_s$ topologically generate every completed local factor as an $\mathcal{O}$ -algebra.

Put $A = \overline{\mathcal{O}[t_\Lambda, h_1, \dots, h_s]} \subset \mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O})$, and let $\mathfrak{m}_\tau$ be the maximal ideal of $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}, \tau}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O})$. The preceding paragraph shows that A surjects onto each

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}, \tau}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O}) / \mathfrak{m}_\tau^n.$$

The maximal ideals $\mathfrak{n}_\tau := \ker(\tau|_A)$ are distinct by hypothesis (2). The kernels of these maps are therefore pairwise comaximal, so the Chinese remainder theorem shows that A surjects onto their product for every n . Thus A is dense in $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(p)}(\mathcal{O})$. Since A is closed by definition, the two algebras are equal. $\square$

2.2.1 $p = 2, 3$

By [Rus19, Theorem 7.2(i)–(ii) and Proposition 3.8(i)], the completed prime-to-2 Hecke algebra is

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(2)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_2[T_3, T_5, t_\Lambda]}, \quad t_\Lambda = [5], \tag{2.3}$$

and the completed prime-to-3 Hecke algebra is

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(3)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_3[T_2, T_7, t_\Lambda]}, \quad t_\Lambda = [4]. \tag{2.4}$$

Consequently, two continuous characters of $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(2)}$ with values in a finite $\mathbf{Z}_2$ -algebra are equal if they agree on T_3 , T_5 , and t_Λ , while two continuous characters of $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(3)}$ with values in a finite $\mathbf{Z}_3$ -algebra are equal if they agree on T_2 , T_7 , and t_Λ .

2.2.2 $p = 5$

Medvedovsky shows that the shallow Hecke algebra at $p = 5$ has four twist-equivalent residual local factors. One of them is

$$\tau_0 := \omega^{-1} + 1$$

where ω is the mod-5 cyclotomic character. Then

$$\mathbb{T}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh},(5)} \simeq \mathbf{F}_5[[x, y]], \quad x := T_{11} - 2, \quad y := T_{19};$$

see [Med15, Theorem 8.1 and §8.5]. We would like to lift this result to obtain generators of $\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(5)}$. The difficulty is that the residual values of T_{11} do not separate the four local factors. We will show that T_{11} may be replaced by T_2 .

Let Δ denote the modular discriminant of weight 12, and let E_4 denote the normalized Eisenstein series of weight 4. Consider the following forms modulo 5:

$$\begin{aligned} f_0 &= 2\Delta + \Delta^2, \\ f_1 &= 3\Delta + 4\Delta^3 + \Delta^4, \\ f_2 &= 3\Delta + \Delta^3 + \Delta^5 + 3\Delta^6 + 2\Delta^7 + 4\Delta^8 + \Delta^9 \\ &\quad + 2\Delta^{11} + 2\Delta^{12} + 4\Delta^{13} + \Delta^{14}. \end{aligned}$$

These are in fact mod 5 reductions of classical modular forms, as can be seen using the identity $E_4 \equiv 1 \pmod{5}$.

The residual T_2 -values on the four local factors are

$$4, \quad 3, \quad 1, \quad 2,$$

with value 4 on τ_0 . Put $s := T_2 - 4$. Then s belongs to $\mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}}$ and is a unit on each of the other three local factors. A direct q -expansion calculation gives

$$\begin{array}{c|ccc} & s & x & y \\ \hline f_0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ f_1 & 3f_0 & 0 & f_0 \\ f_2 & 3f_0 & 4f_0 & 4f_0 \end{array} \tag{2.5}$$

In particular, $s^2 f_i = 0$. Since s is a unit on every residual local factor other than τ_0 , it follows that f_0, f_1, f_2 belong to the τ_0 -primary summand.

We also get from (2.5) that

$$(\mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}})^2 f_i = 0 \quad (i = 0, 1, 2).$$

Since $\mathbb{T}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh},(5)} \simeq \mathbf{F}_5[[x, y]]$, we have

$$\dim_{\mathbf{F}_5} \mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}} / (\mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}})^2 = 2.$$

Suppose

$$\beta s + \gamma y = 0, \quad \beta, \gamma \in \mathbf{F}_5,$$

is a relation in $\mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}} / (\mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}})^2$. Then $\beta s + \gamma y$ annihilates f_1 and f_2 . By (2.5), this forces $\beta = \gamma = 0$. Thus the classes of s and y are linearly independent, and therefore form a basis

of $\mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}}/(\mathfrak{m}_{\tau_0}^{\text{sh}})^2$. Equivalently, the classes of $T_2 - 4$ and T_{19} form a basis of this cotangent space.

By [Med15, Proposition 2.41], twisting by the θ operator permutes the four residual local factors and their cotangent spaces. Under these permutations, the two classes above are carried, up to nonzero scalars, to the classes of

$$T_2 - c_\tau, \quad T_{19},$$

where $c_\tau = \tau(T_2)$. Hence these classes span $\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}}/(\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}})^2$ for every residual eigensystem τ . Moreover, the residual values of T_2 distinguish the four residual eigensystems. Lemma 2.4 therefore gives

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(5)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_5[T_2, T_{19}, t_\Lambda]}, \quad t_\Lambda = [6]. \quad (2.6)$$

2.2.3 $p = 7$

Let ω be the mod-7 cyclotomic character. Medvedovsky shows that the shallow Hecke algebra has nine residual eigensystems

$$\tau_{a,b} = \omega^a + \omega^b, \quad a \in \{0, 2, 4\}, \quad b \in \{1, 3, 5\};$$

see [Med15, Theorem 8.1 and §8.7].

Lemma 2.5. *For $\tau = \tau_{a,b}$, put*

$$c_\tau := \tau(T_3) = 3^a + 3^b \in \mathbf{F}_7.$$

Then the classes of

$$T_3 - c_\tau, \quad T_{29} - 2$$

form a basis of $\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}}/(\mathfrak{m}_\tau^{\text{sh}})^2$.

Proof. Put $d := b - a \in \{1, 3, 5\} \pmod{6}$. By [Med15, Corollary 7.2], we need a prime ℓ such that

$$\ell^d \not\equiv 1 \pmod{7}, \quad \ell^6 \not\equiv 1 \pmod{49}.$$

These conditions are satisfied for $\ell = 3$. Thus $T_3 - c_\tau$ will be one of our generators.

For the other generator, we use Medvedovsky's criterion [Med15, Corollary 7.8]. Put

$$E := \mathcal{O}_{\mathbf{Q}(\zeta_7)}[1/7]^\times,$$

the group of 7-units of $\mathbf{Q}(\zeta_7)$. We need classes $\alpha, \beta \in E/E^7$ lying in the ω^{1-d} - and ω^{1+d} -eigenspaces, respectively. Furthermore, we need a prime $\ell \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$ such that neither α nor β are 7th powers in $\mathbf{F}_\ell$.

For $j \in \{0, 2, 4\}$, put

$$u_j := \prod_{r=1}^6 (1 - \zeta_7^r)^{r^{-j}} \in E/E^7.$$

If $\sigma_c(\zeta_7) = \zeta_7^c$, then

$$\sigma_c(u_j) = u_j^{c^j},$$

so u_j lies in the ω^j -eigenspace of E/E^7 . For $d = 1, 3, 5$, the required pairs of eigenspace exponents are

$$(1 - d, 1 + d) = (0, 2), (4, 4), (2, 0) \pmod{6}.$$

For any prime $\mathfrak{l}$ of $\mathbf{Q}(\zeta_7)$ above 29, the reductions of u_0, u_2, u_4 in

$$\mathcal{O}_{\mathbf{Q}(\zeta_7)}/\mathfrak{l} \simeq \mathbf{F}_{29}$$

are not seventh powers. Thus we can take T_{29} as our second generator. $\square$

The level-one Hecke recursion gives

$$[3] = 3(T_3^2 - T_9), \quad (2.7)$$

so

$$[3] \in \mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(7)}.$$

We apply Lemma 2.4 with

$$\mathcal{H} = \{T_3, T_{29}, [3]\}.$$

Lemma 2.5 verifies hypothesis (1) of Lemma 2.4.

It remains to verify that the residual values of the elements of $\mathcal{H}$ distinguish the nine residual eigensystems. For $\tau = \tau_{a,b}$, we have

$$\tau(T_3) = 3^a + 3^b, \quad \tau([3]) = 3^{a+b+1}.$$

The corresponding pairs are

	$b = 1$	$b = 3$	$b = 5$
$a = 0$	$(4, 2)$	$(0, 4)$	$(6, 1)$
$a = 2$	$(5, 4)$	$(1, 1)$	$(0, 2)$
$a = 4$	$(0, 1)$	$(3, 2)$	$(2, 4)$

These nine pairs are distinct. Hence T_3 and $[3]$ jointly distinguish the nine residual eigensystems, so hypothesis (2) of Lemma 2.4 is satisfied.

Lemma 2.4 therefore gives

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(7)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_7[t_\Lambda, T_3, T_{29}, [3]]}, \quad t_\Lambda = [8].$$

Finally, t_Λ is redundant. The element 3 is a topological generator of $\mathbf{Z}_7^\times$. By continuity of the weight action, $[8]$ belongs to the closed $\mathbf{Z}_7$ -algebra generated by $[3]$. Thus

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(7)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_7[T_3, T_{29}, [3]]}.$$

2.3 Weak realization of cyclotomic packets

To compare a strong eigensystem with a cyclotomic packet through the completed Hecke algebra, we need to know that the packet itself is realized by a genuine weak Hecke eigensystem modulo p^m .

Lemma 2.6 (Weak realization of Eisenstein twists). *Let p be a prime, let $m \geq 1$, let $i \geq m$, and let $\kappa \geq 4$ be even. The reduction of $\theta^i G_\kappa$ modulo p^m is a normalized weak cuspidal eigenform of some weight K satisfying*

$$K \equiv \kappa + 2i \pmod{\varphi(p^m)}.$$

Proof. Put

$$G_\kappa^* := G_\kappa - p^{\kappa-1}G_\kappa \mid V_p.$$

By [Ser73, §1.6 and Théorème 5], $\theta^i G_\kappa^*$ is an integral level-one p -adic modular form of weight $\kappa + 2i$. Since $i \geq m$,

$$\theta^i G_\kappa^* \equiv \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{p^m}.$$

Thus there exist a sufficiently large even weight K and a classical modular form $F \in M_K(\mathbf{Z}_p)$ such that

$$F \equiv \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{p^m}, \quad K \equiv \kappa + 2i \pmod{\varphi(p^m)}.$$

The reduction of F is cuspidal and normalized, since its constant term is zero and its coefficient at q is 1. For every prime $\ell \neq p$, the Hecke formula and the weight congruence give

$$T_\ell F \equiv \ell^i(1 + \ell^{\kappa-1})F \pmod{p^m}.$$

Since $i \geq m$, the coefficients of F at indices divisible by p vanish modulo p^m . Taking $K - 1 \geq m$, the Hecke formula also gives $T_p F \equiv 0 \pmod{p^m}$. Thus the reduction of F , which equals that of $\theta^i G_\kappa$, is a normalized weak cuspidal eigenform. $\square$

Lemma 2.7 (Modularity of the correction term). *Let $p \in \{2, 3, 5, 7\}$, let $m \geq 2$, assuming $m \geq 3$ if $p = 2$, and put $e = \varphi(p^m)$. Let $f \in M_k(\mathcal{O}_f)$, and suppose that $i \geq m$ and $\kappa \geq 4$ is even, with*

$$\kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{e}.$$

If

$$\theta^e f \equiv \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{p^{m-1}}$$

literally, then the reduction of

$$\frac{\theta^e f - \theta^i G_\kappa}{p^{m-1}}$$

modulo the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_f$ is the q -expansion of a modular form over its residue field.

Proof. By the classical approximation used in the preceding proof, there are classical modular forms F_1, F_2 , with coefficients in $\mathcal{O}_f$, satisfying

$$F_1 \equiv \theta^e f \pmod{p^m}, \quad F_2 \equiv \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{p^m},$$

whose weights are both congruent to k modulo e .

Let E_j denote the normalized Eisenstein series of weight j . The modular form

$$H = \begin{cases} E_4^{2^{m-3}}, & p = 2, \\ E_6^{3^{m-2}}, & p = 3, \\ E_{p-1}^{p^{m-1}}, & p = 5, 7 \end{cases}$$

has weight e and satisfies $H \equiv 1 \pmod{p^m}$. Multiplying the form of smaller weight by a suitable power of H , we may therefore assume that F_1 and F_2 have the same weight K , without changing these congruences.

The assumed literal congruence now gives

$$D := \frac{F_1 - F_2}{p^{m-1}} \in M_K(\mathcal{O}_f).$$

Moreover,

$$D \equiv \frac{\theta^e f - \theta^i G_\kappa}{p^{m-1}} \pmod{p}.$$

Reducing D modulo the maximal ideal proves the claim. $\square$

3 Modular symbols of level 1

3.1 Modular symbols with coefficients in R

Let $d \geq 0$ be even, and put

$$\Gamma := \mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbf{Z}).$$

For now, let R be a commutative ring. Let

$$V_d(R) := \mathrm{Sym}^d(R^2)$$

be the R -module of homogeneous polynomials of degree d in X and Y . We regard $V_d(R)$ as a right $\mathbf{Z}[M_2(\mathbf{Z})]$ -module via

$$(P \mid \gamma)(X, Y) := P(aX + bY, cX + dY), \quad \gamma = \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{pmatrix} \in M_2(\mathbf{Z}).$$

Let

$$\mathrm{St}_R := \mathrm{Div}^0(\mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{Q})) \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}} R$$

be the Steinberg module over R . Equivalently, St_R is generated by symbols

$$\{\alpha, \beta\}, \quad \alpha, \beta \in \mathbf{P}^1(\mathbf{Q}),$$

subject to the relations

$$\{\alpha, \alpha\} = 0, \quad \{\alpha, \beta\} + \{\beta, \eta\} + \{\eta, \alpha\} = 0.$$

We equip St_R with the right Γ -action induced by fractional linear transformations, and

$$\mathrm{St}_R \otimes_R V_d(R)$$

with the diagonal right action. Following [Wie09, Notation 2.1 and Definition 3.1], define the *modular symbols of level 1 with coefficients in R* to be the coinvariants

$$\mathbb{M}_d(R) := H_0(\Gamma, \mathrm{St}_R \otimes_R V_d(R)).$$

Let

$$S := \begin{pmatrix} 0 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}, \quad U := \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix}.$$

By [Wie09, Theorem 3.5(1)], there is an isomorphism

$$\mathbb{M}_d(R) \simeq \frac{V_d(R)}{V_d(R)(1+S) + V_d(R)(1+U+U^2)}.$$

We refer to the right-hand side as the *Manin presentation* of $\mathbb{M}_d(R)$. Finally, let

$$\iota := \begin{pmatrix} -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Since ι normalizes Γ , its action on $\mathrm{St}_R \otimes_R V_d(R)$ induces an involution on $\mathbb{M}_d(R)$. For $\epsilon \in \{+1, -1\}$, define

$$\mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R) := \mathbb{M}_d(R)^{\iota=\epsilon} = \ker(\iota - \epsilon).$$

3.2 Hecke operators

For $n \geq 1$ with $(n, p) = 1$, let

$$\mathcal{H}_n := \left\{ \begin{pmatrix} a & b \\ c & \delta \end{pmatrix} \in M_2(\mathbf{Z}) : a > b \geq 0, \quad \delta > c \geq 0, \quad a\delta - bc = n \right\}.$$

By [Mer94, §3.3, Proposition 20, pp. 29–30], the element

$$\sum_{M \in \mathcal{H}_n} M \in \mathbf{Z}[M_2(\mathbf{Z})]$$

satisfies Merel's condition (C_n) . Hence [Mer94, §2.1, Theorem 4, pp. 16–17] gives an operator

$$T_n : \mathbb{M}_d(R) \longrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d(R)$$

which, in the Manin presentation of the preceding subsection, is given by

$$T_n[P] = \sum_{M \in \mathcal{H}_n} [P \mid M].$$

Here it is the sum over the Heilbronn–Merel family that descends to the Manin quotient; the individual maps $P \mapsto P \mid M$ need not do so. Although Merel formulates the Hecke theory over $\mathbf{C}$, the construction is integral: the modular-symbol construction may be carried out over an arbitrary coefficient ring, and these Hecke operators preserve the integral structure [Mer94, §1.1, p. 4 and §2.1, Remark 1, p. 18]. Thus the preceding formula defines T_n on $\mathbb{M}_d(R)$ for every commutative ring R . The operators T_n commute with the involution ι , and hence preserve $\mathbb{M}_d^\pm(R)$; see [Mer94, §2.1, Remark 2, p. 18].

3.3 Comparison with modular forms

Let

$$\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z}) := \mathbb{M}_d(\mathbf{Z}) / \mathbb{M}_d(\mathbf{Z})_{\text{tors}}$$

be the torsion-free quotient of the integral level-one modular-symbol module. Put

$$t := \begin{pmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix},$$

and let $B_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z})$ be the torsion-free quotient of

$$\frac{V_d(\mathbf{Z})}{V_d(\mathbf{Z})(t-1)}.$$

By [Wie09, Theorem 3.5(2)–(3)], the boundary map is defined integrally and induces a homomorphism

$$\partial_d^{\text{tf}} : \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z}) \longrightarrow B_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z}).$$

For $\epsilon \in \{+1, -1\}$, define

$$P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z}) := \left(\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z}) \right)^{\iota=\epsilon}$$

and

$$L_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z}) := \ker \left(\partial_d^{\text{tf}} \Big|_{P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})} \right).$$

The lattice $P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})$ is saturated in $\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z})$. Indeed,

$$\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z})/P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z}) \simeq \text{im}(\iota - \epsilon),$$

and the latter is a subgroup of the torsion-free group $\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z})$. The lattice $L_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})$ is saturated in $P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})$, as can be seen from

$$P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})/L_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z}) \cong \text{im}\left(\partial_d^{\text{tf}} \Big|_{P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})}\right) \subset B_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z}).$$

In particular, $L_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})$ is saturated in $\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z})$.

The Hecke operators preserve $P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})$ and $L_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z})$: they preserve the integral modular-symbol structure, commute with the involution ι , and are compatible with the boundary map; see [Mer94, §2.1, Proposition 11 and the following Remark, p. 18]. After extension of scalars to $\mathbf{C}$, the Eichler-Shimura period pairing, in the modular-symbol formulation of Merel, restricts to a nondegenerate pairing

$$S_{d+2}(\mathbf{C}) \times \left(L_d^+(\mathbf{Z}) \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}} \mathbf{C}\right) \longrightarrow \mathbf{C};$$

see [Mer94, §1.5, Theorem 3, pp. 10–11, and §1.6, Proposition 8, p. 12]. Moreover, the Hecke operators on modular forms and modular symbols are adjoint with respect to this pairing [Mer94, §2.1, Proposition 10, pp. 17–18]. Consequently, $S_{d+2}(\mathbf{C})$ and $L_d^+(\mathbf{Z}) \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}} \mathbf{C}$ carry the same systems of Hecke eigenvalues.

We now pass to local coefficients. For $m \geq 0$, let

$$R_m := \begin{cases} \mathbf{Z}_p, & m = 0, \\ \mathbf{Z}_p/p^m \mathbf{Z}_p, & m \geq 1. \end{cases}.$$

Write

$$\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(R_m) := \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}(\mathbf{Z}) \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}} R_m, \quad P_d^\epsilon(R_m) := P_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z}) \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}} R_m, \quad L_d^\epsilon(R_m) := L_d^\epsilon(\mathbf{Z}) \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}} R_m.$$

When $R_m = \mathbf{Z}_p$, we will simply write $\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}$, P_d^ϵ , and L_d^ϵ . The lattices P_d^ϵ and L_d^ϵ are saturated in $\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}$ and P_d^ϵ , respectively. In particular

$$P_d^\epsilon/p^m P_d^\epsilon \hookrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}/p^m \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}.$$

3.4 Dickson multipliers

Fix $m \geq 1$. Define

$$\alpha_p := \frac{X^{p^2}Y - XY^{p^2}}{X^pY - XY^p} = \sum_{j=0}^p X^{(p-j)(p-1)} Y^{j(p-1)}$$

and

$$\beta_p := X^pY - XY^p.$$

Remark 3.1. The choice of α_p and β_p is motivated by Dickson's theorem on invariants. In dimension 2, this theorem states that

$$\mathbf{F}_p[X, Y]^{\text{GL}_2(\mathbf{F}_p)} = \mathbf{F}_p[\bar{\alpha}_p, \bar{\beta}_p^{p-1}],$$

where bars denote reduction modulo p . See [Ste87, Theorem A, p. 699].

Define

$$A_m := \alpha_p^{p^{m-1}} \quad \text{and} \quad B_m := \beta_p^{p^{m-1}}.$$

Their degrees are

$$a_m := \deg A_m = p^m(p-1), \quad b_m := \deg B_m = p^{m-1}(p+1).$$

The same prime-power lifts of the Dickson invariants occur in Deng's [Den23] study of torsion in the cohomology of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbf{Z})$; his $f_{2,m}$ and $f_{1,m}$ correspond to our A_m and B_m , respectively.

Lemma 3.2. *The reductions*

$$\bar{A}_m, \bar{B}_m \in \mathbf{F}_p[X, Y]$$

are coprime.

Proof. Since

$$\bar{A}_m = \bar{\alpha}_p^{p^{m-1}} \quad \text{and} \quad \bar{B}_m = \bar{\beta}_p^{p^{m-1}},$$

it is enough to prove that $\bar{\alpha}_p$ and $\bar{\beta}_p$ are coprime. Now

$$\bar{\beta}_p = XY(X^{p-1} - Y^{p-1}).$$

The polynomial $\bar{\alpha}_p$ is divisible by neither X nor Y . Moreover, we have

$$\bar{\alpha}_p \equiv (p+1)Y^{p(p-1)} = Y^{p(p-1)} \pmod{X^{p-1} - Y^{p-1}}.$$

Hence any common divisor of $\bar{\alpha}_p$ and $X^{p-1} - Y^{p-1}$ must divide $Y^{p(p-1)}$. Since

$$\gcd(X^{p-1} - Y^{p-1}, Y) = 1,$$

this common divisor is a unit. Thus

$$\gcd(\bar{\alpha}_p, \bar{\beta}_p) = 1,$$

and the result follows. □

Define the coefficient multiplication map

$$\Psi_d : V_{d-a_m}(\mathbf{Z}_p) \oplus V_{d-b_m}(\mathbf{Z}_p) \longrightarrow V_d(\mathbf{Z}_p)$$

by

$$\Psi_d(F, G) := A_m F + B_m G. \tag{3.1}$$

Proposition 3.3 (Surjective coefficient transfer). *If*

$$d \geq a_m + b_m = p^{m-1}(p^2 + 1),$$

then Ψ_d is surjective.

The same numerical cutoff appears in [Den23, Lemma 5.33]: in Deng's notation, the corresponding quotient of polynomial coinvariants vanishes for $d > p^{m+1} + p^{m-1} - 2 = a_m + b_m - 2$.

Proof. By Lemma 3.2, the reductions $\bar{A}_m$ and $\bar{B}_m$ are coprime in $\mathbf{F}_p[X, Y]$. Reducing Ψ_d modulo p , we obtain

$$\bar{\Psi}_d : V_{d-a_m}(\mathbf{F}_p) \oplus V_{d-b_m}(\mathbf{F}_p) \longrightarrow V_d(\mathbf{F}_p), \quad (F, G) \longmapsto \bar{A}_m F + \bar{B}_m G.$$

Suppose

$$\bar{A}_m F + \bar{B}_m G = 0.$$

Since $\bar{A}_m$ and $\bar{B}_m$ are coprime, we have

$$\bar{A}_m \mid G, \quad \bar{B}_m \mid F.$$

Thus there is a unique

$$H \in V_{d-a_m-b_m}(\mathbf{F}_p)$$

such that

$$(F, G) = (-\bar{B}_m H, \bar{A}_m H).$$

Hence

$$\dim_{\mathbf{F}_p} \ker \bar{\Psi}_d = d - a_m - b_m + 1.$$

Since $d \geq a_m + b_m$, it follows that

$$\begin{aligned} \dim_{\mathbf{F}_p} \operatorname{im} \bar{\Psi}_d &= (d - a_m + 1) + (d - b_m + 1) - (d - a_m - b_m + 1) \\ &= d + 1 \\ &= \dim_{\mathbf{F}_p} V_d(\mathbf{F}_p). \end{aligned}$$

Therefore $\bar{\Psi}_d$ is surjective.

The cokernel of Ψ_d is a finitely generated $\mathbf{Z}_p$ -module, and its reduction modulo the maximal ideal (p) is the cokernel of $\bar{\Psi}_d$, which is zero. Nakayama's lemma therefore gives

$$\operatorname{coker} \Psi_d = 0.$$

Thus Ψ_d is surjective. □

3.5 Transfer map for modular symbols

We will now descend the multiplication map (3.1) to a transfer map on modular symbols modulo p^m .

Define the group homomorphism

$$\chi_m : R_m^\times \rightarrow R_m^\times, \quad u \mapsto u^{p^{m-1}}.$$

Lemma 3.4. *Let*

$$\gamma \in M_2(\mathbf{Z}), \quad p \nmid \det \gamma.$$

Then

$$A_m \mid \gamma = A_m, \quad B_m \mid \gamma = \chi_m(\det \gamma) B_m \quad \text{in } R_m[X, Y].$$

Proof. Modulo p , one has

$$\bar{\alpha}_p \mid \gamma = \bar{\alpha}_p, \quad \bar{\beta}_p \mid \gamma = \det(\gamma) \bar{\beta}_p.$$

These identities follow by a direct calculation. Raising them to the power p^{m-1} gives the stated congruences modulo p^m , by the binomial theorem. □

Proposition 3.5. *The coefficient multiplication map of (3.1) induces a homomorphism*

$$\Psi_d : \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}(R_m) \longrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d(R_m).$$

Moreover, if $p \nmid n$, then

$$T_n \circ \Psi_d = \Psi_d(T_n \oplus \chi_m(n)T_n). \quad (3.2)$$

If

$$d \geq a_m + b_m = p^{m-1}(p^2 + 1),$$

then Ψ_d is surjective.

Proof. For

$$F \in V_{d-a_m}(R_m), \quad G \in V_{d-b_m}(R_m),$$

Lemma 3.4 gives

$$\begin{aligned} \Psi_d(F, G) \mid \gamma &= (A_m F + B_m G) \mid \gamma \\ &= (A_m \mid \gamma)(F \mid \gamma) + (B_m \mid \gamma)(G \mid \gamma) \\ &= A_m(F \mid \gamma) + \chi_m(\det \gamma)B_m(G \mid \gamma) \\ &= \Psi_d(F \mid \gamma, \chi_m(\det \gamma)(G \mid \gamma)). \end{aligned} \quad (3.3)$$

Since

$$\det S = \det U = 1,$$

it follows that

$$\Psi_d(F, G) \mid S = \Psi_d(F \mid S, G \mid S)$$

and

$$\Psi_d(F, G) \mid U = \Psi_d(F \mid U, G \mid U).$$

Hence Ψ_d preserves the Manin relations, and therefore descends to

$$\Psi_d : \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}(R_m) \longrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d(R_m).$$

Now let $p \nmid n$. Every matrix $M \in \mathcal{H}_n$ has determinant n , so (3.3) gives

$$\begin{aligned} T_n \Psi_d(F, G) &= \sum_{M \in \mathcal{H}_n} \Psi_d(F, G) \mid M \\ &= \sum_{M \in \mathcal{H}_n} \Psi_d(F \mid M, \chi_m(n)(G \mid M)) \\ &= \Psi_d(T_n F, \chi_m(n)T_n G). \end{aligned}$$

This proves (3.2).

Finally, if

$$d \geq p^{m-1}(p^2 + 1),$$

then the coefficient multiplication map is surjective by Proposition 3.3. Hence the induced map on the Manin quotients is also surjective. $\square$

3.6 For odd p

In this subsection, suppose that p is odd. For $\epsilon \in \{+1, -1\}$, the idempotents

$$e^\epsilon := \frac{1 + \epsilon\iota}{2}$$

are defined over $\mathbf{Z}_p$ and R_m . We have

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R_m) &= e^\epsilon \mathbb{M}_d(R_m), \\ P_d^\epsilon &= \left(\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}\right)^\epsilon = e^\epsilon \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}, \\ \left(\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}/p^m \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}\right)^\epsilon &= e^\epsilon \left(\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}/p^m \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}\right) = P_d^\epsilon/p^m P_d^\epsilon. \end{aligned} \tag{3.4}$$

Moreover,

$$\mathbb{M}_d(R_m) = \mathbb{M}_d^+(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_d^-(R_m), \tag{3.5}$$

with e^ϵ acting as the identity on $\mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R_m)$.

Since p^{m-1} is odd, Lemma 3.4 gives

$$A_m \mid \iota = A_m, \quad B_m \mid \iota = -B_m \tag{3.6}$$

in $R_m[X, Y]$. Thus multiplication by A_m preserves the ι -sign, whereas multiplication by B_m reverses it.

Proposition 3.6. *Suppose that p is odd. For each*

$$\epsilon \in \{+1, -1\},$$

there is a map

$$\Psi_d^\epsilon : \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}(R_m) \rightarrow \mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R_m),$$

satisfying

$$T_n \circ \Psi_d^\epsilon = \Psi_d^\epsilon(T_n \oplus \chi_m(n)T_n) \quad ((n, p) = 1). \tag{3.7}$$

Moreover, if

$$d \geq p^{m-1}(p^2 + 1),$$

then Ψ_d^ϵ is surjective. In particular, for $\epsilon = +1$, composing with the quotient map to $P_d^+/p^m P_d^+$ gives a surjection

$$\Phi_d : \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}^+(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}^-(R_m) \twoheadrightarrow P_d^+/p^m P_d^+. \tag{3.8}$$

Proof. For $F \in \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}(R_m)$ and $G \in \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}(R_m)$, we have, by (3.6),

$$e^\epsilon \Psi_d(F, G) = \Psi_d(e^\epsilon F, e^{-\epsilon} G).$$

Thus, defining Ψ_d^ϵ as the restriction of Ψ_d to $\mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}(R_m)$, we see that the image of Ψ_d^ϵ lands in $\mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R_m)$. By Proposition 3.5, it is twisted Hecke-equivariant, and surjective if $d \geq p^{m-1}(p^2 + 1)$.

Composing with the natural surjection

$$\mathbb{M}_d(R_m) \twoheadrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}/p^m \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}$$

and applying e^+ gives (3.8). □

3.7 Propagation of Hecke operator relations

The transfer maps above allow relations on Hecke operators in lower coefficient degrees to be propagated to higher degrees.

By abuse of notation, we extend the character χ_m to an endomorphism of the polynomial algebra in the prime-to- p Hecke operators by

$$\chi_m(T_n) := \chi_m(n)T_n = n^{p^{m-1}}T_n \quad ((n, p) = 1).$$

Let F be a polynomial, with coefficients in R_m , in finitely many prime-to- p Hecke operators. For

$$\epsilon \in \{+1, -1\},$$

the twisted Hecke equivariance of Proposition 3.6 gives

$$F \circ \Psi_d^\epsilon = \Psi_d^\epsilon(F \oplus \chi_m(F)). \quad (3.9)$$

Corollary 3.7 (One-step propagation). *Suppose that p is odd and*

$$d \geq p^{m-1}(p^2 + 1).$$

Let $\epsilon \in \{+1, -1\}$. If

$$F\mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m) = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad \chi_m(F)\mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}(R_m) = 0,$$

then

$$F\mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R_m) = 0.$$

In particular, for $\epsilon = +1$,

$$F(P_d^+/p^m P_d^+) = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad F(L_d^+(R_m)) = 0.$$

Proof. The first assertion follows from (3.9) and the surjectivity of Ψ_d^ϵ granted by Proposition 3.5. The final assertion follows by passing to the quotient

$$\mathbb{M}_d^+(R_m) \twoheadrightarrow P_d^+/p^m P_d^+$$

and then restricting to $L_d^+(R_m)$. □

Theorem 3.8 (Weight propagation). *Suppose that p is odd, and let r be an even integer with $0 \leq r < 2p^{m-1}$. Let F be a polynomial, with coefficients in R_m , in finitely many prime-to- p Hecke operators. For $q \geq 0$ put*

$$\epsilon_q := (-1)^q.$$

Suppose that, for every q ,

$$\chi_m^q(F)\mathbb{M}_{r+2jp^{m-1}}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m) = 0 \quad \left(\frac{p+1}{2} \leq j < \frac{p^2+1}{2} \right).$$

Then, for every $j \geq \frac{p+1}{2}$ and every q ,

$$\chi_m^q(F)\mathbb{M}_{r+2jp^{m-1}}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m) = 0.$$

Consequently, for every even $d \geq p^{m-1}(p+1)$ satisfying $d \equiv r \pmod{2p^{m-1}}$,

$$F(P_d^+/p^m P_d^+) = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad F(L_d^+/p^m L_d^+) = 0.$$

Proof. For ease of reading, let us introduce

$$u := \frac{p(p-1)}{2}, \quad v := \frac{p+1}{2}, \quad J := u + v = \frac{p^2+1}{2}.$$

Then

$$a_m = 2p^{m-1}u, \quad b_m = 2p^{m-1}v.$$

Write

$$d_j := r + 2p^{m-1}j.$$

Then the transfer map can be written as

$$\Psi_{d_j}^\epsilon : \mathbb{M}_{d_j-u}^\epsilon(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d_j-v}^{-\epsilon}(R_m) \rightarrow \mathbb{M}_{d_j}^\epsilon(R_m).$$

In this notation, the surjectivity condition of Proposition 3.6 can be written as $j \geq J$.

We argue by strong induction on j . There is nothing to prove for $v \leq j < J$. Suppose that $j \geq J$. We quickly check that

$$j - u \geq J - u = v, \quad j - v \geq J - v = u \geq v.$$

By Proposition 3.6,

$$\Psi_{d_j}^{\epsilon_q} : \mathbb{M}_{d_j-u}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d_j-v}^{-\epsilon_q}(R_m) \twoheadrightarrow \mathbb{M}_{d_j}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m)$$

is surjective. Recall that the second summand in the domain carries the twist χ_m .

By the induction hypothesis,

$$\chi_m^q(F) \mathbb{M}_{d_j-u}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m) = 0$$

and

$$\chi_m^{q+1}(F) \mathbb{M}_{d_j-v}^{\epsilon_q+1}(R_m) = 0.$$

By Corollary 3.7,

$$\chi_m^q(F) \mathbb{M}_{d_j}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m) = 0,$$

finishing the induction.

Taking $q = 0$ gives the assertion on $\mathbb{M}_d^+(R_m)$, and hence on $P_d^+/p^m P_d^+$ and $L_d^+/p^m L_d^+$. $\square$

Remark 3.9. More generally, the Hecke relation may depend periodically on the coefficient degree. The same induction applies to a finite family F_d , provided that the family is closed under the two transitions

$$(d, F_d, \epsilon) \mapsto (d - a_m, F_d, \epsilon)$$

and

$$(d, F_d, \epsilon) \mapsto (d - b_m, \chi_m(F_d), -\epsilon).$$

For $p = 2$, the determinant twist is trivial. We state the simpler propagation statement.

Theorem 3.10 (Weight propagation for $p = 2$). *Suppose that $p = 2$ and $m \geq 2$. Let r be an even integer with*

$$0 \leq r < 2^{m-1},$$

and let F be a polynomial, with coefficients in R_m , in finitely many odd Hecke operators. Suppose that

$$F \mathbb{M}_{r+j2^{m-1}}(R_m) = 0 \quad (2 \leq j \leq 4).$$

Then

$$F\mathbb{M}_{r+j2^{m-1}}(R_m) = 0$$

for every $j \geq 2$.

Consequently, for every even $d \geq 2^m$ satisfying $d \equiv r \pmod{2^{m-1}}$,

$$F\left(P_d^+/2^m P_d^+\right) = 0 \quad \text{and} \quad F\left(L_d^+/2^m L_d^+\right) = 0.$$

Proof. By strong induction on j , using the degree shifts

$$a_m = 2^m, \quad b_m = 3 \cdot 2^{m-1}.$$

□

3.8 Calculus of linear relations

To obtain higher congruences, we need polynomial relations in divided Hecke operators such as T/p^α . Division need not define an endomorphism on the finite modular-symbol modules used in the transfer argument. We therefore encode it by the linear relation $Tx = p^\alpha y$. Such relations pass through the transfer maps and yield ordinary operator congruences after passage to the free lattice.

We use the basic calculus of linear relations developed by Arens [Are61, § 2], who also observes that its elementary constructions extend to modules over a ring. We introduce presentations of relations to make their compatibility with module homomorphisms explicit. Let R be a commutative ring. If M is an R -module, we define an R -linear relation on M to be an R -submodule of $M \oplus M$. We denote by $\text{LinRel}_R(M)$ the set of all R -linear relations on M . Any R -linear map $T \in \text{End}_R(M)$ gives rise to such a relation via its graph

$$\Gamma_T := \{(x, Tx) : x \in M\}.$$

If $\mathcal{A} \in \text{LinRel}_R(M)$ and $x, y \in M$, write $x\mathcal{A}y$ to mean that $(x, y) \in \mathcal{A}$. For a sequence $x_0, x_1, \dots, x_n \in M$, write

$$x_0\mathcal{A}x_1\mathcal{A}\dots\mathcal{A}x_n$$

to mean that

$$x_0\mathcal{A}x_1, \quad x_1\mathcal{A}x_2, \quad \dots \quad x_{n-1}\mathcal{A}x_n.$$

Let

$$\mathcal{A}(x) := \{y \in M : (x, y) \in \mathcal{A}\}.$$

Define the domain of $\mathcal{A}$ as

$$\text{dom } \mathcal{A} := \{x \in M : \mathcal{A}(x) \neq \emptyset\}.$$

If $\mathcal{A}, \mathcal{B} \in \text{LinRel}_R(M)$ and $r \in R$, define

$$\mathcal{A} + \mathcal{B} := \{(x, y + z) : (x, y) \in \mathcal{A}, (x, z) \in \mathcal{B}\},$$

$$r\mathcal{A} = \{(x, ry) : (x, y) \in \mathcal{A}\},$$

$$\mathcal{A}\mathcal{B} = \{(x, z) : \exists y \in M, (x, y) \in \mathcal{B}, (y, z) \in \mathcal{A}\}.$$

If $f : M \rightarrow N$ is R -linear, we get a map $f_* : \text{LinRel}_R(M) \rightarrow \text{LinRel}_R(N)$ defined as follows: we have an R -linear map

$$f \oplus f : M \oplus M \rightarrow N \oplus N,$$

and for every $\mathcal{A} \in \text{LinRel}_R(M)$, we can define

$$f_*(\mathcal{A}) := (f \oplus f)(\mathcal{A}).$$

Now we make a more universal definition. Define a *presentation of a linear relation over R* to be a triple $\mathfrak{P} := (P, p_0, p_1)$ of an R -module P with two distinguished elements $p_0, p_1 \in P$. For the connection with pp-definable relations when P is finitely presented, see [Pre09]. If $\mathfrak{P}$ is a presentation of a linear relation over R and M is an R -module, let

$$\mathfrak{P}(M) := \{(\phi(p_0), \phi(p_1)) : \phi \in \text{Hom}_R(P, M)\}.$$

Thus $\mathfrak{P}(M) \in \text{LinRel}_R(M)$. Moreover, if $f : M \rightarrow N$ is R -linear, then

$$f_*\mathfrak{P}(M) \subset \mathfrak{P}(N).$$

Consequently,

$$f(\text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(M)) \subseteq \text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(N).$$

In particular, if f is surjective and $\text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(M) = M$, then $\text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(N) = N$. Presentations also commute with finite direct sums:

$$\mathfrak{P}(M_1 \oplus M_2) = \mathfrak{P}(M_1) \oplus \mathfrak{P}(M_2),$$

$$\text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(M_1 \oplus M_2) = \text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(M_1) \oplus \text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(M_2).$$

We now define the sum, product, and scalar action on presentations of linear relations over R . Let $\mathfrak{P} = (P, p_0, p_1)$ and $\mathfrak{Q} = (Q, q_0, q_1)$ be two such relations. Define

$$\mathfrak{P} + \mathfrak{Q} := \left(\frac{P \oplus Q}{R(p_0, -q_0)}, \bar{p}_0 = \bar{q}_0, \overline{p_1 + q_1} \right)$$

where bars denote images in the quotient. Also define

$$\mathfrak{P}\mathfrak{Q} := \left(\frac{Q \oplus P}{R(q_1, -p_0)}, \bar{q}_0, \bar{p}_1 \right).$$

For $r \in R$, define $r\mathfrak{P} := (P, p_0, rp_1)$. Then, for every M ,

$$(\mathfrak{P} + \mathfrak{Q})(M) = \mathfrak{P}(M) + \mathfrak{Q}(M),$$

$$(\mathfrak{P}\mathfrak{Q})(M) = \mathfrak{P}(M)\mathfrak{Q}(M),$$

$$(r\mathfrak{P})(M) = r\mathfrak{P}(M).$$

Finally, let

$$\mathbf{1}_R := (R, 1, 1).$$

Then there are canonical isomorphisms

$$\mathfrak{P}\mathbf{1}_R \cong \mathbf{1}_R\mathfrak{P} \cong \mathfrak{P}.$$

Let us remark that we can make these definitions functorially. Consider the functor

$$\mathcal{U} : R\text{-Mod} \rightarrow R\text{-Mod}, \quad \mathcal{U}(M) := M \oplus M.$$

Then a *linear relation* $\mathcal{P}$ over R is a subfunctor $\mathcal{P} \subset \mathcal{U}$. If $\mathfrak{P} = (P, p_0, p_1)$ is a presentation of a linear relation over R , then the image subfunctor

$$\mathcal{P}_{\mathfrak{P}} := \text{im}(\text{Hom}_R(P, -) \rightarrow \mathcal{U})$$

is a linear relation over R . Note however that not every linear relation will have a presentation.

We now specify how to evaluate a polynomial at linear relations. For a linear relation $\mathcal{A}$ on M , put

$$\mathcal{A}^0 := \Gamma_{\text{id}_M}, \quad \mathcal{A}^{n+1} := \mathcal{A}\mathcal{A}^n.$$

Thus, for $n \geq 1$,

$$\mathcal{A}^n(x_0) = \{x_n \in M : \exists x_1, \dots, x_{n-1} \in M, x_0 \mathcal{A} x_1 \mathcal{A} \cdots \mathcal{A} x_n\}.$$

For a nonzero polynomial

$$F(X) = \sum_{j=0}^n c_j X^j \in R[X],$$

define

$$F(\mathcal{A}) := \sum_{j: c_j \neq 0} c_j \mathcal{A}^j.$$

For the zero polynomial, put $F(\mathcal{A}) := \Gamma_0$. More generally, if

$$F(X_1, \dots, X_s) = \sum_j c_j X_1^{j_1} \cdots X_s^{j_s},$$

we define

$$F(\mathcal{A}_1, \dots, \mathcal{A}_s) := \sum_{j: c_j \neq 0} c_j \mathcal{A}_1^{j_1} \cdots \mathcal{A}_s^{j_s}.$$

The order of composition is the displayed order, with the rightmost relation applied first. Different monomials may use different intermediate elements.

These definitions use the expanded polynomial. Evaluation at multivalued relations need not respect polynomial addition or multiplication; in particular, algebraic simplifications of expressions in relations are not automatically valid. For commuting endomorphisms $T_1, \dots, T_s$, however,

$$F(\Gamma_{T_1}, \dots, \Gamma_{T_s}) = \Gamma_{F(T_1, \dots, T_s)}.$$

For $F(X) = \sum_{j=0}^n c_j X^j$, any common chain

$$x_0 \mathcal{A} x_1 \mathcal{A} \cdots \mathcal{A} x_n$$

gives

$$\left(x_0, \sum_{j=0}^n c_j x_j \right) \in F(\mathcal{A}).$$

Thus a computation using a common chain supplies an element of the polynomial relation defined above.

We will now define the *divided operator* linear relation. Let $T, S \in R$. Define a presentation of a linear relation over R by

$$\mathfrak{D}_{T,S} := \left(\frac{R \oplus R}{R(Te_0 - Se_1)}, \bar{e}_0, \bar{e}_1 \right), \quad e_0 := (1, 0), \quad e_1 := (0, 1).$$

Then on an R -module M ,

$$\mathfrak{D}_{T,S}(M) = \{(x, y) : Tx = Sy\}.$$

If $\text{dom } \mathfrak{D}_{T,S}(M) = M$, we will say that M admits a division relation of T by S and symbolically write

$${}''\frac{T}{S} := \mathfrak{D}_{T,S}(M).$$

We now specialize a bit more towards our intended applications. Let A be a commutative $\mathbf{Z}_p$ -algebra, and let L be an A -module that is finite free over $\mathbf{Z}_p$. Fix $m \geq 1$, and let M be an $A/p^m A$ -module equipped with an $A/p^m A$ -linear surjection

$$q : M \twoheadrightarrow L/p^m L.$$

We apply the preceding definitions over the ring $A/p^m A$. Elements of A acting on M are understood through their images in $A/p^m A$.

Let $\mathcal{B}$ be a linear relation on M , and let $0 \leq b \leq m$. We write

$$\mathcal{B} \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b} \quad \text{on } M$$

if

$$\mathcal{B}(x) \cap p^b M \neq \emptyset \quad \text{for every } x \in M.$$

Equivalently, for every $x \in M$, there exists $y \in p^b M$ such that $(x, y) \in \mathcal{B}$.

For an endomorphism T of M , this definition gives

$$\Gamma_T \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b} \iff TM \subseteq p^b M.$$

More generally, for $T \in A$,

$$\mathcal{B}\Gamma_T \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b}$$

means that

$$\mathcal{B}(Tu) \cap p^b M \neq \emptyset \quad \text{for every } u \in M.$$

For a presentation $\mathfrak{P}$ over $A/p^m A$, put

$$\mathfrak{I} := \mathfrak{D}_{1, p^b} \mathfrak{P}.$$

Then

$$\mathfrak{I}(M) = \{(x, \rho) : \exists y \in \mathfrak{P}(M)(x), y = p^b \rho\}.$$

Consequently,

$$\mathfrak{P}(M) \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b} \iff \text{dom } \mathfrak{I}(M) = M.$$

Thus congruence conditions for presented relations pass through surjective module homomorphisms and hold on a finite direct sum whenever they hold on each summand.

Proposition 3.11 (Division and retained precision). *In the preceding setup, let $T_1, \dots, T_s \in A$, and let $1 \leq \alpha_i < m$. Put*

$$\mathcal{Z}_i := \mathfrak{D}_{T_i, p^{\alpha_i}}(M).$$

For each i , if $\text{dom } \mathcal{Z}_i = M$, then

$$T_i L \subseteq p^{\alpha_i} L.$$

Consequently,

$$Z_i := \frac{T_i}{p^{\alpha_i}}$$

defines an endomorphism of L .

Suppose now that all the Z_i preserve L , whether established this way or separately, and put

$$h := m - \max_i \alpha_i.$$

Let $F \in \mathbf{Z}_p[X_1, \dots, X_s]$, let $S \in A$, and let $0 \leq b \leq h$. If

$$F(Z_1, \dots, Z_s)\Gamma_S \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b} \quad \text{on } M,$$

then

$$SF(Z_1, \dots, Z_s)L \subseteq p^b L.$$

Here the coefficients of F on the source are understood through their images in $A/p^m A$.

Proof. Suppose first that $\text{dom } Z_i = M$. For $u \in L$, choose $x \in M$ with $q(x) = u \pmod{p^m L}$, and choose $y \in M$ satisfying

$$T_i x = p^{\alpha_i} y.$$

Applying q gives

$$T_i u \in p^{\alpha_i} L + p^m L = p^{\alpha_i} L.$$

This proves the first assertion.

Now assume that all the Z_i preserve L . Let

$$q_h : M \twoheadrightarrow L/p^h L$$

be the composite of q with reduction modulo p^h . If $(x, y) \in \mathcal{Z}_i$, applying q and cancelling p^{α_i} on the free lattice gives

$$q_h(y) = Z_i q_h(x),$$

since $h \leq m - \alpha_i$. Thus every choice of output of $\mathcal{Z}_i$ has, after applying q_h , the same value as the integral operator Z_i . Following the intermediate elements in each monomial, we therefore obtain

$$q_h(y) = F(Z_1, \dots, Z_s)q_h(x)$$

whenever

$$(x, y) \in F(\mathcal{Z}_1, \dots, \mathcal{Z}_s).$$

For any $u \in L$, choose $x \in M$ lifting its class modulo $p^m L$. By hypothesis, there is $y \in p^b M$ such that

$$(Sx, y) \in F(\mathcal{Z}_1, \dots, \mathcal{Z}_s).$$

Consequently,

$$F(Z_1, \dots, Z_s)Su \in p^b L + p^h L = p^b L.$$

Since A is commutative, $S, Z_1, \dots, Z_s$ commute on $L \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}_p} \mathbf{Q}_p$, and hence on L . This gives the stated inclusion. $\square$

3.9 Propagation of divided Hecke relations

Fix $m \geq 1$, and assume $m \geq 2$ if $p = 2$. Recall that $R_m = \mathbf{Z}/p^m\mathbf{Z}$, and put

$$\mathbb{A} := \mathbf{Z}_p[t_n : (n, p) = 1], \quad \mathbb{A}_m := \mathbb{A}/p^m\mathbb{A} = R_m[t_n : (n, p) = 1].$$

For odd p , put $\epsilon_q = (-1)^q$. We regard

$$\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(R_m)$$

as an $\mathbb{A}_m$ -module by letting t_n act as $\chi_m(n)^q T_n$. With these actions, the transfer map

$$\Psi_d^{\epsilon_q} : \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}^{\epsilon_{q+1}}(R_m) \longrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(R_m)$$

is $\mathbb{A}_m$ -linear and is surjective when $d \geq a_m + b_m$. Here the two source modules carry the actions associated with orientations q and $q + 1$, respectively.

For $p = 2$, let t_n act as T_n on $\mathbb{M}_d(R_m)$. The transfer map

$$\Psi_d : \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}(R_m) \longrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d(R_m)$$

is $\mathbb{A}_m$ -linear and surjective in the same range.

Proposition 3.12 (Propagation of presented relations). *Let $\mathfrak{P}$ be a presentation of a linear relation over $\mathbb{A}_m$.*

Suppose first that p is odd, and let r be an even integer with $0 \leq r < 2p^{m-1}$. Assume that

$$\text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(\mathbb{M}_{r+2jp^{m-1}}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m)) = \mathbb{M}_{r+2jp^{m-1}}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m)$$

for every $q \geq 0$ and every integer j satisfying

$$\frac{p+1}{2} \leq j < \frac{p^2+1}{2},$$

with the $\mathbb{A}_m$ -actions specified above. Then the same equality holds for every $j \geq (p+1)/2$ and every $q \geq 0$.

For $p = 2$, let r be an even integer with $0 \leq r < 2^{m-1}$. If

$$\text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(\mathbb{M}_{r+j2^{m-1}}(R_m)) = \mathbb{M}_{r+j2^{m-1}}(R_m) \quad (2 \leq j \leq 4),$$

then the same equality holds for every $j \geq 2$.

In both cases, the same conclusion holds with the full-domain condition replaced by the congruence

$$\mathfrak{P}(\mathbb{M}_{r+2jp^{m-1}}^{\epsilon_q}(R_m)) \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b},$$

or its unsplit analogue for $p = 2$, where $0 \leq b \leq m$.

Proof. Use the same strong induction on j as in Theorems 3.8 and 3.10. At each step, the induction hypothesis gives full domain on both source modules, hence on their direct sum. Full domain then passes through the surjective transfer map.

For congruences, apply the same argument to the presentation

$$\mathfrak{D}_{1,p^b}\mathfrak{P}.$$

□

As r varies, the initial degrees are exactly the even degrees in the ranges

$$b_m \leq d < a_m + b_m \quad (p \text{ odd}),$$

and

$$2^m \leq d < 5 \cdot 2^{m-1} \quad (p = 2).$$

For odd p , the specified module structures are periodic in q with period $p - 1$, so only finitely many orientations need to be checked.

As in Remark 3.9, the presentation may depend on degree residues and orientation. The same induction applies provided that, at each transfer step, the source conditions are those of the target presentation evaluated on the two source modules with their respective $\mathbb{A}_m$ -actions. Thus any family closed under the two degree transitions propagates in the same way. One may likewise restrict to degree residues closed under these transitions.

To obtain operator congruences, take orientation $q = 0$ and use

$$\mathbb{M}_d^+(R_m) \twoheadrightarrow P_d^+ / p^m P_d^+ \quad (p \text{ odd}),$$

or

$$\mathbb{M}_d(R_m) \twoheadrightarrow \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}} / 2^m \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}} \quad (p = 2).$$

Give the free lattices their $\mathbb{A}$ -module structures by letting t_n act as T_n . Proposition 3.11, applied with $A = \mathbb{A}$, then establishes integrality of the divided operators and the resulting polynomial congruences on the free lattice, under its stated hypotheses.

These conclusions restrict to L_d^+ . Indeed, the numerator Hecke operators preserve L_d^+ , and saturation implies that their integral divided operators preserve it as well. For $p = 2$, these operators also commute with ι , by cancellation on the torsion-free module, and hence preserve P_d^+ . Finally, saturation gives

$$L_d^+ \cap p^b P_d^+ = p^b L_d^+$$

for odd p , and

$$L_d^+ \cap 2^b \mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}} = 2^b L_d^+$$

for $p = 2$.

Relations with prescribed inputs are included in the same argument. For example,

$$F(\mathcal{Z}_1, \dots, \mathcal{Z}_s) \Gamma_S \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b}$$

is a presented relation, with the action of S twisted along with the numerator operators.

3.10 Recursive computation of Manin quotients and ideal images

The transfer map allows a recursive and fast computation of the Manin quotients. We describe the procedure here. Fix $m \geq 1$, assuming $m \geq 2$ if $p = 2$. Let $d \geq 0$ be even and $R_m = \mathbf{Z}/p^m \mathbf{Z}$. We use the convention that $V_d(R_m) = 0$ if $d < 0$.

Suppose $d < a_m + b_m$. By the proof of Proposition 3.3, the transfer map

$$\Psi_d : V_{d-a_m}(R_m) \oplus V_{d-b_m}(R_m) \longrightarrow V_d(R_m)$$

is injective. In fact, its reduction over $\mathbf{F}_p$ is injective, hence it is split injective. Thus there exists a free R_m -submodule $W_d \subseteq V_d(R_m)$ such that

$$V_d(R_m) = A_m V_{d-a_m}(R_m) \oplus B_m V_{d-b_m}(R_m) \oplus W_d. \quad (3.10)$$

The complement W_d need not be stable under $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbf{Z})$. Since W_d is a direct summand of a finite free module over the local ring R_m , it is itself finite free.

Put

$$H_d := \mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}(R_m).$$

Define an R_m -linear surjection

$$\rho_d : V_d(R_m) \longrightarrow H_d \oplus W_d, \quad A_m F + B_m G + w \longmapsto ([F], [G], w).$$

Let $\mathcal{R}_d$ be the R_m -submodule generated by

$$\rho_d(w + w \mid S), \quad \rho_d(w + w \mid U + w \mid U^2),$$

as w ranges over a basis of W_d .

Proposition 3.13. *The map*

$$([F], [G], w) \longmapsto [A_m F + B_m G + w]$$

induces an isomorphism of R_m -modules

$$(H_d \oplus W_d)/\mathcal{R}_d \simeq \mathbb{M}_d(R_m).$$

Proof. For each nonnegative degree e , put

$$N_e := V_e(R_m)(1 + S) + V_e(R_m)(1 + U + U^2).$$

Terms involving negative degrees below are omitted. By (3.10) and the definition of ρ_d , we have

$$\ker \rho_d = A_m N_{d-a_m} + B_m N_{d-b_m}.$$

Since A_m and B_m are invariant under S and U ,

$$N_d = A_m N_{d-a_m} + B_m N_{d-b_m} + W_d(1 + S) + W_d(1 + U + U^2).$$

Consequently,

$$\ker \rho_d \subseteq N_d, \quad \rho_d(N_d) = \mathcal{R}_d.$$

Therefore

$$\mathbb{M}_d(R_m) = \frac{V_d(R_m)}{N_d} \simeq \frac{V_d(R_m)/\ker \rho_d}{N_d/\ker \rho_d} \simeq \frac{H_d \oplus W_d}{\mathcal{R}_d}.$$

□

The Hecke actions can also be computed recursively. For $(n, p) = 1$, define an endomorphism of $H_d \oplus W_d$ by

$$\tilde{T}_n(x, y, w) = (T_n x, \chi_m(n) T_n y, 0) + \rho_d \left(\sum_{\gamma \in \mathcal{H}_n} w \mid \gamma \right).$$

By twisted Hecke equivariance of the transfer map, this endomorphism preserves $\mathcal{R}_d$ and induces T_n on the quotient of Proposition 3.13. Thus only the Hecke images of a basis of W_d need to be computed directly.

For odd p , the construction is compatible with the plus/minus decomposition. Applying the projections $e^\pm$, we may choose complements separately in the two eigenspaces:

$$V_d(R_m)^\epsilon = A_m V_{d-a_m}(R_m)^\epsilon \oplus B_m V_{d-b_m}(R_m)^{-\epsilon} \oplus W_d^\epsilon.$$

Taking $W_d = W_d^+ \oplus W_d^-$ gives an ι -stable complement. Since $A_m \mid \iota = A_m$ and $B_m \mid \iota = -B_m$, the map ρ_d is equivariant for the involution

$$(x, y, w) \mapsto (\iota x, -\iota y, \iota w)$$

on $H_d \oplus W_d$. In particular, $\mathcal{R}_d$ is stable under this involution. Applying $e^\epsilon = (1 + \epsilon\iota)/2$ therefore gives

$$\mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R_m) \simeq \frac{\mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m) \oplus \mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}(R_m) \oplus W_d^\epsilon}{e^\epsilon \mathcal{R}_d}.$$

To compute $e^\epsilon \mathcal{R}_d$, form the relations from a basis of all of W_d and then project. In particular, the U -relations must include starting vectors of both signs. The induced Hecke operators preserve these signed quotients. For $p = 2$, we use the unsplit construction.

The same construction permits recursive verification of presented linear relations. Give the first lower quotient the usual $\mathbb{A}_m$ -action and the second the action $t_n \mapsto \chi_m(n)T_n$. The maps induced by multiplication by A_m and B_m are then $\mathbb{A}_m$ -linear. Let $\mathfrak{P}$ be a presentation over $\mathbb{A}_m$. If $\mathfrak{P}$ has full domain on both lower quotients, functoriality shows that their images lie in

$$\text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(\mathbb{M}_d(R_m)).$$

It therefore suffices to check

$$[w] \in \text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(\mathbb{M}_d(R_m))$$

for each vector w in a basis of W_d . Indeed, this domain is a submodule, and these classes together with the transferred generators generate $\mathbb{M}_d(R_m)$. Likewise, a congruence

$$\mathfrak{P}(\mathbb{M}_d(R_m)) \equiv 0 \pmod{p^b}$$

can be verified recursively by applying this argument to the presentation $\mathfrak{D}_{1,p^b} \mathfrak{P}$.

The preceding constructions also apply to ideal images. Let $I \subseteq \mathbb{A}_m$ be an ideal. For odd p , give $\mathbb{M}_d^\epsilon(R_m)$ and $\mathbb{M}_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m)$ the action $t_n \mapsto \chi_m(n)^q T_n$, and $\mathbb{M}_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}$ the action $t_n \mapsto \chi_m(n)^{q+1} T_n$. The transfer map restricts to

$$\Psi_d^\epsilon : IM_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m) \oplus IM_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}(R_m) \longrightarrow IM_d^\epsilon(R_m).$$

This restriction is surjective when $d \geq a_m + b_m$. Indeed, the transfer is $\mathbb{A}_m$ -linear with the specified actions, and a surjective $\mathbb{A}_m$ -linear map $f : M \rightarrow N$ satisfies $f(IM) = IN$. For $p = 2$, the same statement holds for the unsplit modules, with no twist.

Since taking ideal images also commutes with finite direct sums, the same induction proves propagation of ordinary operator relations and full-domain conditions for presented relations on these ideal images, with the initial degree ranges of Proposition 3.12. Families depending on degree and orientation must satisfy the same transition compatibility conditions. Congruences of presented relations are interpreted within the ideal images, so the terminal submodule is $p^b IM_d^\epsilon(R_m)$.

For odd p and $d < a_m + b_m$, the recursive presentation gives

$$\begin{aligned} IM_d^\epsilon(R_m) &= \Psi_d^\epsilon \left(IM_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m) \oplus IM_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}(R_m) \right) \\ &\quad + \sum_{f \in I} f[W_d^\epsilon], \end{aligned}$$

where $[W_d^\epsilon]$ denotes the image of W_d^ϵ in the Manin quotient, and f acts through the target orientation. If $I = (f_1, \dots, f_s)$, this equality becomes

$$\begin{aligned} \text{IM}_d^\epsilon(R_m) &= \Psi_d^\epsilon \left(\text{IM}_{d-a_m}^\epsilon(R_m) \oplus \text{IM}_{d-b_m}^{-\epsilon}(R_m) \right) \\ &\quad + \sum_{j=1}^s f_j[W_d^\epsilon]. \end{aligned}$$

For $p = 2$, use the corresponding unsplit construction.

For recursive verification of a presented relation $\mathfrak{P}$, suppose it has full domain on both lower ideal images. It then suffices to check

$$f_j[w] \in \text{dom } \mathfrak{P}(\text{IM}_d^\epsilon(R_m))$$

for each ideal generator f_j and each vector w in a basis of W_d^ϵ . Congruences are treated by applying the same argument to $\mathfrak{D}_{1,p^b}\mathfrak{P}$.

Part II

Computations and classifications

Throughout this part, let f be a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform of weight k , and let $\mathcal{O}_f$ be the ring of integers of a finite extension of $\mathbf{Q}_p$ containing the coefficients of f . We put

$$d := k - 2, \quad r \equiv d \pmod{p^{m-1}(p-1)}, \quad 0 \leq r < p^{m-1}(p-1).$$

4 The prime 2: classification modulo 256

For every even residue $r \bmod 128$, put

$$c_{3,r} := 1 + 3^{r+1} \pmod{256}, \quad c_{5,r} := 1 + 5^{r+1} \pmod{256},$$

and define

$$X_r := T_3 - c_{3,r}.$$

Also put

$$\varepsilon_r := \begin{cases} 1, & r \equiv 0, 6, 8, 14 \pmod{16}, \\ 0, & r \equiv 2, 4, 10, 12 \pmod{16}. \end{cases}$$

Although r is taken modulo 128, these quantities depend only on $r \bmod 64$.

4.1 Certified Hecke operator identities

Put

$$F_r(Z) := Z^2 - \varepsilon_r Z.$$

The computation is performed at precision 256. For $m = 8$, the Dickson multipliers have degrees

$$a_8 = 256, \quad b_8 = 384, \quad \text{with } a_8 + b_8 = 640.$$

Hence the exact induction base in Proposition 3.12 consists, for every even $0 \leq r < 128$, of the three degrees

$$d = r + j \cdot 128, \quad 2 \leq j \leq 4.$$

Equivalently, these are the 192 even degrees

$$256 \leq d \leq 638.$$

For every such degree d , put

$$\mathcal{Z}_r := \frac{t_3 - c_{3,r}}{2^7} = \mathfrak{D}_{t_3 - c_{3,r}, 2^7}(\mathbb{M}_d(\mathbf{Z}/256\mathbf{Z})),$$

where $r \equiv d \pmod{128}$ and t_3 acts as T_3 . The computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/blob/main/playground_mod_256.ipynb] verifies

$$\text{dom } \mathcal{Z}_r = \mathbb{M}_d(\mathbf{Z}/256\mathbf{Z}), \quad F_r(\mathcal{Z}_r) \equiv 0 \pmod{2},$$

and also verifies the ordinary relation

$$(T_5 - c_{5,r})\mathbb{M}_d(\mathbf{Z}/256\mathbf{Z}) = 0.$$

Since both a_8 and b_8 are divisible by 128, the quantities $c_{3,r}$, $c_{5,r}$, and ε_r are unchanged under the two transitions of Remark 3.9. Thus these families satisfy the compatibility required for propagation.

Proposition 3.12 propagates these conditions to every even degree

$$d \geq 256.$$

The remaining even degrees

$$0 \leq d < 256$$

are verified directly. By Proposition 3.11, with $m = 8$, $\alpha_1 = 7$, $b = 1$, and $S = 1$, for

$$r \equiv d \pmod{128},$$

the operator

$$Z_r := \frac{T_3 - c_{3,r}}{2^7}$$

belongs to

$$\text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_2}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}),$$

preserves P_d^+ and L_d^+ , and satisfies

$$(Z_r^2 - \varepsilon_r Z_r)\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}} \subseteq 2\mathbb{M}_d^{\text{tf}}, \quad (Z_r^2 - \varepsilon_r Z_r)L_d^+ \subseteq 2L_d^+. \quad (4.1)$$

Likewise, Theorem 3.10, together with the direct verification in the lower degrees, gives

$$(T_5 - c_{5,r})L_d^+ \subseteq 256L_d^+. \quad (4.2)$$

Thus both relations hold in every even coefficient degree d .

4.2 Congruences for a_3 and a_5

By the Eichler–Shimura comparison recalled in Section 3.3, choose a primitive simultaneous eigenvector

$$v_f \in L_d^+ \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}_2} \mathcal{O}_f$$

for the prime-to-2 Hecke eigensystem of f .

Since Z_r preserves L_d^+ , its eigenvalue on v_f is integral. Thus

$$z_3 := \frac{a_3(f) - c_{3,r}}{2^7} \in \mathcal{O}_f.$$

Evaluating (4.1) on v_f gives

$$z_3^2 - \varepsilon_r z_3 \in 2\mathcal{O}_f.$$

If $\varepsilon_r = 0$, then

$$z_3^2 \in 2\mathcal{O}_f,$$

so $v_2(z_3) > 0$. Hence

$$v_2(a_3(f) - c_{3,r}) > 7,$$

which is precisely

$$a_3(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} c_{3,r} \pmod{256}.$$

If $\varepsilon_r = 1$, then

$$z_3(z_3 - 1) \in 2\mathcal{O}_f.$$

The two factors differ by a unit, so exactly one of them belongs to the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_f$. Therefore

$$z_3 \equiv 0 \quad \text{or} \quad 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}},$$

and consequently

$$a_3(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} c_{3,r} \quad \text{or} \quad c_{3,r} + 2^7 \pmod{256}.$$

Finally, evaluating (4.2) on v_f gives the literal, and hence valuative, congruence

$$a_5(f) \equiv_{\text{lit}} c_{5,r} \pmod{256}.$$

Thus

$$a_3(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} \begin{cases} c_{3,r} & \pmod{256}, & \varepsilon_r = 0, \\ c_{3,r} \text{ or } c_{3,r} + 128 & \pmod{256}, & \varepsilon_r = 1, \end{cases} \quad a_5(f) \equiv_{\text{lit}} c_{5,r} \pmod{256}. \quad (4.3)$$

4.3 Final classification

Proof of Theorem 1.4. For $r \equiv k - 2 \pmod{128}$, direct calculation gives

	a_3	a_5	
$\theta^{64}G_k$	$c_{3,r}$	$c_{5,r}$	
$\theta^{16}G_{k+32}$	$c_{3,r} + 128$	$c_{5,r}$	$\pmod{256}.$

Thus (4.3) selects $\theta^{64}G_k$ when $\varepsilon_r = 0$, and exactly one of the two twists when $\varepsilon_r = 1$.

Write the selected twist as $\theta^i G_\kappa$. By Lemma 2.6, its reduction modulo 256 is a weak eigenform of weight congruent to $\kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{64}$. It therefore agrees with f at the weight operator $[5]$, as well as at T_3 and T_5 , modulo 256 in the valuative sense. Since

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(2)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_2[T_3, T_5, [5]]},$$

the two prime-to-2 Hecke eigensystems agree. As $n^{64} \equiv 1 \pmod{256}$ for odd n , and both twists vanish modulo 256 at even indices, this gives

$$\theta^{64} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{256}.$$

Conversely, for every even weight residue modulo 64, the computation supplies a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform realizing each permitted pair of T_3 - and T_5 -values in that weight residue. The same completed-Hecke generation argument proves agreement of the entire prime-to-2 eigensystems.

Different weight residues are distinguished by

$$a_3(f)^2 - a_9(f) = 3^{k-1},$$

since 3 has order 64 modulo 256. Within a weight residue, the two permitted systems, when both occur, are distinguished by their T_3 -values. There are $32 + 16 = 48$ permitted systems altogether, and every one is realized. $\square$

5 The prime 3: classification modulo 81

Throughout this section, put

$$r \equiv d = k - 2 \pmod{54}, \quad 0 \leq r < 54.$$

We call $r \equiv 2 \pmod{6}$, equivalently $k \equiv 4 \pmod{6}$, the *zero branch*, and $r \equiv 0, 4 \pmod{6}$, equivalently $k \equiv 0, 2 \pmod{6}$, the *nonzero branch*. As a consequence of the calculations below, these branches are also characterized by

$$\begin{aligned} \text{zero branch} &\iff a_2(f) \in 9\mathcal{O}_f, \\ \text{nonzero branch} &\iff a_2(f) \notin 9\mathcal{O}_f. \end{aligned}$$

5.1 Certified Hecke operator identities

5.1.1 The common T_7 relation

Let $t_r \in \{0, \dots, 80\}$ represent $1 + 7^{r+1} \pmod{81}$. We work at precision 81, where

$$a_4 = 162, \quad b_4 = 108, \quad a_4 + b_4 = 270.$$

For every even degree $0 \leq d < 270$ and both orientations $q \in \{0, 1\}$, put

$$\mathcal{N}_{r,q} := \frac{t_7 - t_r}{27} = \mathfrak{D}_{t_7 - t_r, 27}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/81\mathbf{Z})), \quad \epsilon_q = (-1)^q.$$

Here t_7 acts as T_7 , since $\chi_4(7) = 7^{27} \equiv 1 \pmod{81}$. The computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/blob/main/playground_mod_81.ipynb] verifies

$$\text{dom } \mathcal{N}_{r,q} = \mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/81\mathbf{Z}), \quad \mathcal{N}_{r,q}^2 \equiv 0 \pmod{3}.$$

Both degree shifts preserve $r \pmod{54}$. Proposition 3.12, together with the direct verification in degrees $d < 108$, therefore propagates these conditions to every even degree. Proposition 3.11, with $m = 4$, $\alpha_1 = 3$, $b = 1$, and $S = 1$, gives

$$N_r := \frac{T_7 - t_r}{27} \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_3}(P_d^+), \quad N_r^2 P_d^+ \subseteq 3P_d^+.$$

These conclusions restrict to L_d^+ by saturation.

5.1.2 The nonzero branch

Suppose $r \equiv 0, 4 \pmod{6}$. Define c_r by

$$\begin{array}{c|cccccccccccccccccccc} r & 0 & 4 & 6 & 10 & 12 & 16 & 18 & 22 & 24 & 28 & 30 & 34 & 36 & 40 & 42 & 46 & 48 & 52 \\ \hline c_r & 1 & 4 & 4 & 1 & 7 & -2 & 10 & -5 & 13 & -8 & 16 & 16 & -8 & 13 & -5 & 10 & -2 & 7 \end{array} \quad (5.1)$$

Put $F(X) := X^4 - 2X^3 + X^2$. We work at precision 243, where

$$a_5 = 486, \quad b_5 = 324, \quad a_5 + b_5 = 810.$$

For every even degree

$$0 \leq d < 810, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{54},$$

and both orientations $q \in \{0, 1\}$, put

$$\mathcal{Q}_{r,q} := \frac{t_2^2 - 9c_r}{81} = \mathfrak{D}_{t_2^2 - 9c_r, 81}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/243\mathbf{Z})), \quad \epsilon_q = (-1)^q,$$

where t_2 acts as $\chi_5(2)^q T_2 = (-1)^q T_2$. The computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/blob/main/playground_mod_81.ipynb] verifies

$$\text{dom } \mathcal{Q}_{r,q} = \mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/243\mathbf{Z}), \quad F(\mathcal{Q}_{r,q}) \equiv 0 \pmod{3}.$$

Both degree shifts preserve $r \pmod{54}$, and the twist leaves t_2^2 unchanged. Hence Proposition 3.12, together with the direct verification in degrees $d < 324$, propagates these conditions to every even degree $d \equiv r \pmod{54}$. Proposition 3.11, with $m = 5$, $\alpha_1 = 4$, $b = 1$, and $S = 1$, gives

$$Q_r := \frac{T_2^2 - 9c_r}{81} \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_3}(P_d^+), \quad F(Q_r)P_d^+ \subseteq 3P_d^+.$$

By saturation, these conclusions restrict to L_d^+ :

$$Q_r L_d^+ \subseteq L_d^+, \quad (Q_r(Q_r - 1))^2 L_d^+ \subseteq 3L_d^+. \quad (5.2)$$

5.1.3 The zero branch

Suppose $r \equiv 2 \pmod{6}$. We work at precision 2187, where

$$a_7 = 4374, \quad b_7 = 2916, \quad a_7 + b_7 = 7290.$$

Put $I = (9, t_2) \subseteq \mathbb{A}$. For every degree

$$0 \leq d < 7290, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{54},$$

and both orientations $q \in \{0, 1\}$, we work on

$$IM_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/2187\mathbf{Z}), \quad \epsilon_q = (-1)^q,$$

where t_2 acts as $\chi_7(2)^q T_2 = (-1)^q T_2$.

Define the polynomials $h_r(X) \in \mathbf{Z}[X]$ by

r	$h_r(X)$
$2, 8, 20, 26, 38, 44$	$1 - X^2$
14	$2 + 5X$
$32, 50$	$2 + X^2$

and put

$$G_r(X) := (X^3 - X)^2 + 3h_r(X)(X^3 - X).$$

On the above ideal image, define the linear relations

$$\mathcal{A}_q := \frac{t_2''}{9} = \mathfrak{D}_{t_2, 9}(IM_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/2187\mathbf{Z})),$$

and

$$\mathcal{B}_{r,q} := \frac{G_r(\mathcal{A}_q)''}{9} = \mathfrak{D}_{1,9} \circ G_r(\mathcal{A}_q).$$

Here $G_r(\mathcal{A}_q)$ is evaluated using the expanded polynomial convention. All these relations are formed on $IM_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/2187\mathbf{Z})$; in particular, every intermediate element introduced in a composition or division belongs to this ideal image.

Define the sets $E_{r,s}$ by

r	$E_{r,0}$	$E_{r,1}$	$E_{r,2}$
$2, 20, 38$	$\{0, 2\}$	$\{0, 1\}$	$\{0, 1\}$
$8, 26, 44$	$\{0, 2\}$	$\{1, 2\}$	$\{1, 2\}$
14	$\{0, 2\}$	$\{0, 2\}$	$\{0, 1\}$
$32, 50$	$\{0, 2\}$	$\{0, 1\}$	$\{0, 1\}$

and put

$$F_0(Y) := (Y^3 - Y)^2, \quad F_{r,s}(X, Y) := (1 - (X - s)^2)^6 \prod_{\delta \in E_{r,s}} (Y - \delta)^2 \quad (s = 0, 1, 2).$$

These polynomials are expanded before evaluation at the linear relations. In each monomial $X^i Y^j$, the relation $\mathcal{B}_{r,q}$ is applied first, followed by $\mathcal{A}_q$. For every degree and orientation in the above range, the computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/blob/main/playground_mod_81.ipynb] verifies

$$F_0(\mathcal{B}_{r,q}) \equiv 0 \pmod{3}, \quad F_{r,s}(\mathcal{A}_q, \mathcal{B}_{r,q}) \equiv 0 \pmod{3} \quad (s = 0, 1, 2) \quad (5.3)$$

on $IM_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/2187\mathbf{Z})$.

Both degree shifts preserve $r \pmod{54}$, and the ideal $I = (9, t_2)$ is unchanged by the twist $t_2 \mapsto -t_2$. The presentations are therefore compatible with both transfer transitions. By the ideal-image version of Proposition 3.12 discussed in Section 3.10, the verification in

$$2916 \leq d < 7290, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{54},$$

propagates (5.3) to every degree $d \geq 2916$ in this residue class. Together with the direct verification in degrees $d < 2916$, this establishes these relations in every zero-branch degree, for both orientations.

We now take $q = 0$ and put

$$J_d := 9P_d^+ + T_2P_d^+ \subseteq P_d^+.$$

This is a Hecke-stable lattice containing $9P_d^+$. The natural surjection

$$\mathbb{M}_d^+(\mathbf{Z}/2187\mathbf{Z}) \twoheadrightarrow P_d^+/3^7P_d^+$$

restricts to a surjection

$$I\mathbb{M}_d^+(\mathbf{Z}/2187\mathbf{Z}) \twoheadrightarrow J_d/3^7P_d^+.$$

Since $9P_d^+ \subseteq J_d$, we have $3^7P_d^+ \subseteq 3^5J_d$, and hence a surjection

$$I\mathbb{M}_d^+(\mathbf{Z}/2187\mathbf{Z}) \twoheadrightarrow J_d/3^5J_d.$$

Thus (5.3) also holds on $J_d/3^5J_d$.

The first relation implies that $\mathcal{B}_{r,0}$ has full domain, since $F_0(Y)$ is monic of degree 6. Since $G_r(X)$ is also monic of degree 6, the definition of $\mathcal{B}_{r,0}$ then implies that $\mathcal{A}_0$ has full domain. Consequently,

$$T_2J_d \subseteq 9J_d, \quad A := \frac{T_2}{9} \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_3}(J_d).$$

Cancelling 9 in the defining equation for $\mathcal{A}_0$ shows that every value of $\mathcal{A}_0(x)$ agrees with Ax modulo 3^3J_d . The same is therefore true for $G_r(\mathcal{A}_0)$ and $G_r(A)$.

Full domain of $\mathcal{B}_{r,0}$ now gives

$$G_r(A)J_d \subseteq 9J_d, \quad B_r := \frac{G_r(A)}{9} \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_3}(J_d).$$

Cancelling 9 once more shows that every value of $\mathcal{B}_{r,0}(x)$ agrees with $B_r x$ modulo $3J_d$. Thus (5.3) gives

$$F_0(B_r)J_d \subseteq 3J_d, \quad F_{r,s}(A, B_r)J_d \subseteq 3J_d \quad (s = 0, 1, 2). \quad (5.4)$$

5.2 Congruences for a_2 and a_7

5.2.1 Congruence for a_7

By the Eichler–Shimura comparison recalled in Section 3.3, choose a primitive simultaneous eigenvector

$$v_f \in L_d^+ \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}_3} \mathcal{O}_f.$$

Since $N_r = (T_7 - t_r)/27$ preserves L_d^+ and $N_r^2 L_d^+ \subseteq 3L_d^+$, its eigenvalue

$$n_7 := \frac{a_7(f) - t_r}{27}$$

satisfies $n_7 \in \mathcal{O}_f$ and $n_7^2 \in 3\mathcal{O}_f$. Hence $v_3(n_7) \geq \frac{1}{2}$, giving

$$a_7(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} t_r \equiv_{\text{val}} 1 + 7^{k-1} \pmod{81}. \quad (5.5)$$

5.2.2 The nonzero branch

Suppose $r \equiv 0, 4 \pmod{6}$. Since $Q_r = (T_2^2 - 9c_r)/81$ preserves L_d^+ , its eigenvalue

$$q_2 := \frac{a_2(f)^2 - 9c_r}{81}$$

is integral. Consequently,

$$a_2(f)^2 = 9(c_r + 9q_2).$$

Since $c_r \equiv 1 \pmod{3}$, the factor $c_r + 9q_2$ is a unit. Thus $v_3(a_2(f)) = 1$, and

$$z_2 := \frac{a_2(f)}{3} \in \mathcal{O}_f^\times, \quad z_2^2 = c_r + 9q_2.$$

By (5.2),

$$(q_2(q_2 - 1))^2 \in 3\mathcal{O}_f.$$

Reducing modulo the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_f$ therefore gives $\bar{q}_2 \in \{0, 1\}$. Hence

$$z_2^2 \equiv_{\text{val}} c_r \quad \text{or} \quad c_r + 9 \pmod{27}.$$

Both c_r and $c_r + 9$ are congruent to 1 modulo 3, so each has exactly two square roots modulo 27. These roots are simple modulo 3. It follows that

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 3u \pmod{81} \quad \text{for some } u \in \mathbf{Z}/27\mathbf{Z} \text{ satisfying } u^2 \equiv c_r \text{ or } c_r + 9 \pmod{27}. \quad (5.6)$$

Thus there are four possible values of $a_2(f)$ modulo 81 on each nonzero weight residue.

5.2.3 The zero branch

Suppose $r \equiv 2 \pmod{6}$. Since J_d contains $9P_d^+$, it spans the same $\mathbf{Q}_3$ -vector space as P_d^+ . We may therefore choose a primitive simultaneous eigenvector for f in $J_d \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}_3} \mathcal{O}_f$. The integral operators A and B_r have eigenvalues

$$x_2 := \frac{a_2(f)}{9} \in \mathcal{O}_f, \quad y_2 := \frac{(x_2^3 - x_2)^2 + 3h_r(x_2)(x_2^3 - x_2)}{9} \in \mathcal{O}_f.$$

In particular, $a_2(f) \in 9\mathcal{O}_f$.

Put $c = x_2^3 - x_2$. Since

$$c^2 + 3h_r(x_2)c = c(c + 3h_r(x_2)) \in 9\mathcal{O}_f,$$

we have $c \in 3\mathcal{O}_f$: otherwise $v_3(c) < 1$, so $v_3(c + 3h_r(x_2)) = v_3(c)$, giving

$$v_3(c(c + 3h_r(x_2))) = 2v_3(c) < 2,$$

a contradiction. Thus

$$u_2 := \frac{x_2^3 - x_2}{3} \in \mathcal{O}_f, \quad y_2 = u_2^2 + h_r(x_2)u_2.$$

The factorization $x_2^3 - x_2 = x_2(x_2 - 1)(x_2 + 1)$ shows that there is a unique $s \in \{0, 1, 2\}$ such that

$$x_2 \equiv_{\text{lit}} s \pmod{3}.$$

Evaluating (5.4) and reducing modulo the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_f$ gives

$$\bar{y}_2^3 = \bar{y}_2, \quad \prod_{\delta \in E_{r,s}} (\bar{y}_2 - \delta)^2 = 0.$$

Indeed, the selector $(1 - (x_2 - s)^2)^6$ reduces to 1. Consequently,

$$\bar{y}_2 \in E_{r,s}, \quad \bar{u}_2^2 + \overline{h_r(s)} \bar{u}_2 \in E_{r,s}.$$

Write $x_2 = s + 3v_2$, with $v_2 \in \mathcal{O}_f$. Then

$$u_2 = \frac{x_2^3 - x_2}{3} \equiv \frac{s^3 - s}{3} - v_2 \pmod{3\mathcal{O}_f}.$$

Thus $\bar{u}_2$, together with s , determines $a_2(f) = 9s + 27v_2$ modulo 81 in the valuative sense.

Choose $\omega \in \overline{\mathbf{Z}}_3$ with $\omega^2 = 2$. Solving the preceding quadratic conditions gives

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} \alpha \pmod{81} \quad \text{for some } \alpha \in \mathcal{S}_r, \quad (5.7)$$

where

r	$\mathcal{S}_r$
2, 14, 20, 32, 38, 50	$\{0, 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72\}$
8, 26, 44	$\{0, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 9 \pm 27\omega, 72 \pm 27\omega\}.$

Indeed, in the first row the permitted values of $\bar{u}_2$ are precisely $\mathbf{F}_3$ for every s . In the second row they are $\mathbf{F}_3$ when $s = 0$, and $\{\pm 1, \pm \bar{\omega}\}$ when $s = 1, 2$.

5.3 Final classification

Proof of Theorem 1.5. By the preceding subsections, every normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform f determines a unique signature

$$\sigma = (r, \alpha), \quad r \equiv k - 2 \pmod{54}, \quad 0 \leq r < 54,$$

such that

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} \alpha \pmod{81}, \quad a_7(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} t_r \pmod{81}.$$

The permitted values are listed by weight residue $k \equiv r + 2 \pmod{54}$ in Table 3. There are

$$18 \cdot 4 + 6 \cdot 9 + 3 \cdot 11 = 159$$

such signatures altogether.

The finite computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/tree/main/strong_signatures/p3_m4] verifies that every signature is realized by a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform g_σ of weight $k_\sigma \leq 214$, with

$$k_\sigma - 2 \equiv r \pmod{54}.$$

This includes the 147 rational signatures and the 12 nonrational signatures, the latter occurring in six conjugate pairs.

If f has signature σ , then

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_2(g_\sigma) \pmod{81}, \quad a_7(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_7(g_\sigma) \pmod{81},$$

and $k_\sigma \equiv k \pmod{54}$. Hence

$$4^{k_\sigma} \equiv 4^k \pmod{81},$$

so f and g_σ also have the same value of the weight operator [4] modulo 81. By (2.4),

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(3)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_3[T_2, T_7, [4]]}.$$

Their prime-to-3 Hecke eigensystems are therefore congruent modulo 81 in the valuative sense:

$$a_n(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_n(g_\sigma) \pmod{81} \quad ((n, 3) = 1).$$

Conversely, suppose that eigenforms f and g , of weights k and K , have congruent prime-to-3 Hecke eigensystems modulo 81. The identities

$$a_2(f)^2 - a_4(f) = 2^{k-1}, \quad a_2(g)^2 - a_4(g) = 2^{K-1}$$

give

$$2^{k-1} \equiv_{\text{val}} 2^{K-1} \pmod{81}.$$

Since these are rational integers, this congruence is literal. As 2 has order 54 modulo 81, we obtain $k \equiv K \pmod{54}$. Agreement at T_2 then implies that their corresponding values α agree. Thus distinct signatures give distinct eigensystems.

Reducing the signatures modulo 27, direct calculation shows that their values at T_2 and T_7 agree with those of the Eisenstein twists corresponding to the pairs in Theorem 1.5. For each signature, the pair is unique. Choose representatives $i \geq 4$ and even $\kappa \geq 4$ such that

$$\{i, i + \kappa - 1\} = \{a, b\} \quad \text{in } \mathbf{Z}/18\mathbf{Z}, \quad \kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{54}.$$

These congruences at T_2 and T_7 are literal modulo 27. By Lemma 2.6, $\theta^i G_\kappa$ is a weak cuspidal eigenform modulo 27, with the same value of [4] as f . Equation (2.4) therefore gives

$$a_n(f) \equiv n^i \sigma_{\kappa-1}(n) \pmod{27} \quad ((n, 3) = 1).$$

Since $n^{54} \equiv 1 \pmod{27}$ for $3 \nmid n$, and both twisted series vanish modulo 27 at indices divisible by 3, this proves

$$\theta^{54} f \equiv_{\text{lit}} \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{27}.$$

By Lemma 2.7,

$$\delta_f := \frac{\overline{\theta^{54} f - \theta^i G_\kappa}}{27}$$

is a modular form satisfying

$$\theta^{54} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^i G_\kappa + 27\delta_f \pmod{81}.$$

For fixed i, κ , equation (2.4) shows that its q -expansion is determined by the signature and is defined over the residue field of $\mathbf{Q}_3(\alpha)$. Thus δ_f is defined over $\mathbf{F}_3$ for rational signatures and over $\mathbf{F}_9$ otherwise.

Consequently, there are exactly 159 prime-to-3 Hecke eigensystems modulo 81, in the valuative sense, and every such eigensystem is realized in weight at most 214. $\square$

6 The prime 5: classification modulo 125

Throughout this section, put

$$r \equiv d = k - 2 \pmod{100}, \quad 0 \leq r < 100.$$

For every even residue $r \pmod{100}$, define the constants $\alpha_r, \beta_r, \gamma_r, v_r, h_{r,0}, h_{r,1}, h_{r,2}$ by Table 1.

Table 1: Constants for the classification modulo 125.

r	α_r	β_r	γ_r	v_r	$h_{r,0}$	$h_{r,1}$	$h_{r,2}$	r	α_r	β_r	γ_r	v_r	$h_{r,0}$	$h_{r,1}$	$h_{r,2}$
0	1	3	0	4	104	19	1	50	4	3	0	21	21	19	4
2	2	0	3	20	116	4	4	52	3	4	4	5	9	4	1
4	4	0	1	12	64	14	1	54	3	4	3	13	61	14	4
6	4	3	0	15	106	24	4	56	1	0	4	10	19	24	1
8	2	0	0	19	124	9	1	58	2	3	3	6	1	9	4
10	0	3	0	6	121	19	4	60	0	3	0	19	4	19	1
12	0	4	4	0	34	4	1	62	0	0	3	0	91	4	4
14	3	4	3	13	36	14	4	64	4	0	1	12	89	14	1
16	4	0	4	15	44	24	1	66	1	3	0	10	81	24	4
18	1	3	3	21	101	9	4	68	3	0	0	4	24	9	1
20	4	3	0	9	29	19	1	70	1	3	0	16	96	19	4
22	3	0	3	5	66	4	4	72	2	4	4	20	59	4	1
24	4	0	1	12	114	14	1	74	3	4	3	13	11	14	4
26	3	3	0	5	56	24	4	76	2	0	4	20	69	24	1
28	4	0	0	14	49	9	1	78	0	3	3	11	76	9	4
30	2	3	0	1	71	19	4	80	3	3	0	24	54	19	1
32	4	4	4	15	84	4	1	82	1	0	3	10	41	4	4
34	3	4	3	13	111	14	4	84	4	0	1	12	14	14	1
36	0	0	4	0	94	24	1	86	0	3	0	0	31	24	4
38	4	3	3	1	51	9	4	88	0	0	0	24	74	9	1
40	2	3	0	14	79	19	1	90	3	3	0	11	46	19	4
42	4	0	3	15	16	4	4	92	1	4	4	10	109	4	1
44	4	0	1	12	39	14	1	94	3	4	3	13	86	14	4
46	2	3	0	20	6	24	4	96	3	0	4	5	119	24	1
48	1	0	0	9	99	9	1	98	3	3	3	16	26	9	4

Put

$$H_r(X) := \alpha_r + \beta_r X + \gamma_r X^2$$

and

$$N_r(X) := (X^5 - X)^2 - 5H_r(X)(X^5 - X). \quad (6.1)$$

6.1 Certified Hecke operator identities

We work at precision 625. The Dickson multipliers have degrees

$$a_4 = 2500, \quad b_4 = 750, \quad a_4 + b_4 = 3250.$$

The induction base consists of the even degrees

$$750 \leq d \leq 3248,$$

with all four orientations $q \in \{0, 1, 2, 3\}$. On

$$\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z}), \quad \epsilon_q = (-1)^q,$$

the formal operators t_2 and t_{19} act as

$$t_2 = \chi_4(2)^q T_2 = 2^{125q} T_2, \quad t_{19} = \chi_4(19)^q T_{19} = 19^{125q} T_{19}.$$

In orientation q , we use the constants with subscript $d + 50q$, where the subscript is understood modulo 100. The remaining even degrees $0 \leq d < 750$ are verified directly in the untwisted plus orientation $q = 0$.

For every degree and orientation in the above verification ranges, the computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/blob/main/playground_mod_125.ipynb] verifies

$$\begin{aligned} (t_2^2 - h_{d+50q,0} - h_{d+50q,1}t_{19} - h_{d+50q,2}t_{19}^2)\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z}) \\ \subseteq 125\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z}). \end{aligned} \tag{6.2}$$

On the same module, put

$$\mathcal{Z}_{19,q} := \frac{t_{19}}{5} = \mathfrak{D}_{t_{19},5}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z}))$$

and

$$\mathcal{B}_{r,q} := \frac{N_{d+50q}(\mathcal{Z}_{19,q})}{25} = \mathfrak{D}_{1,25} \circ N_{d+50q}(\mathcal{Z}_{19,q}).$$

Here $N_{d+50q}(\mathcal{Z}_{19,q})$ is evaluated using the expanded polynomial convention. All these relations are formed on $\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z})$; in particular, every intermediate element introduced in a composition or division belongs to this module. The computation verifies

$$\text{dom } \mathcal{Z}_{19,q} = \text{dom } \mathcal{B}_{r,q} = \mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z}). \tag{6.3}$$

Write $\bar{v}_r$ for the reduction of v_r modulo 5, and put

$$u_r := \frac{v_r^5 - v_r}{5} \bmod 5, \quad \Lambda_r := \{\bar{v}_r, \bar{v}_r + 2, \bar{v}_r - 2\} \subseteq \mathbf{F}_5.$$

The constants in Table 1 satisfy

$$H_r(\bar{v}_r) = 2u_r \quad \text{in } \mathbf{F}_5.$$

For $\ell \in \mathbf{F}_5$, let $P_{r,\ell}(Y) \in \mathbf{Z}[Y]$ be a lift of

$$\bar{P}_{r,\ell}(Y) := \begin{cases} 1, & \ell \notin \Lambda_r, \\ (Y + u_r^2)^4, & \ell = \bar{v}_r, \\ \left(\prod_{t \in \mathbf{F}_5} (Y - t^2 + H_r(\ell)t) \right)^4, & \ell \in \Lambda_r \setminus \{\bar{v}_r\}. \end{cases}$$

For $\ell \in \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4\}$, put

$$E_\ell(X) := (1 - (X - \ell)^4)^5, \quad \mathcal{E}_{\ell,q} := E_\ell(\mathcal{Z}_{19,q}),$$

and

$$\mathcal{J}_{r,\ell,q} := \mathcal{E}_{\ell,q} \circ \mathcal{B}_{r,q} \circ \mathcal{E}_{\ell,q}.$$

Polynomial evaluation uses the expanded polynomial convention. For every degree and orientation in the above verification ranges, the computation verifies

$$P_{d+50q,\ell}(\mathcal{J}_{r,\ell,q}) \circ \mathcal{E}_{\ell,q} \equiv 0 \pmod{5} \quad (\ell = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4) \quad (6.4)$$

on $\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z})$.

These conditions are closed under the two transitions of Remark 3.9. Indeed, the A_4 -transition sends

$$(d, q) \mapsto (d - 2500, q),$$

while the B_4 -transition sends

$$(d, q) \mapsto (d - 750, q + 1)$$

and reverses the sign. Both transitions preserve the subscripts of the constants, since

$$(d - 2500) + 50q \equiv d + 50q \pmod{100}, \quad (d - 750) + 50(q + 1) \equiv d + 50q \pmod{100}.$$

The change in orientation accounts for the twist of the Hecke operators. Since $\chi_4^4 = \text{id}$, the four orientations suffice.

Thus the same strong-induction argument as in Proposition 3.12 propagates (6.2), (6.3), and (6.4) to every even degree $d \geq 750$, for all four orientations. Together with the direct verification in even degrees $d < 750$, this establishes these conditions in every even degree in the untwisted plus orientation.

We now take $q = 0$ and pass through the natural surjection

$$\mathbb{M}_d^+(\mathbf{Z}/625\mathbf{Z}) \twoheadrightarrow P_d^+/625P_d^+.$$

Full domain of $\mathcal{Z}_{19,0}$ gives

$$T_{19}P_d^+ \subseteq 5P_d^+, \quad Z_{19} := \frac{T_{19}}{5} \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_5}(P_d^+).$$

Cancelling 5 in its defining equation shows that every value of $\mathcal{Z}_{19,0}$, after passage to the target, agrees with Z_{19} modulo $125P_d^+$. The same is therefore true for $N_r(\mathcal{Z}_{19,0})$ and $N_r(Z_{19})$.

Full domain of $\mathcal{B}_{r,0}$ now gives

$$N_r(Z_{19})P_d^+ \subseteq 25P_d^+, \quad B_r := \frac{N_r(Z_{19})}{25} \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_5}(P_d^+).$$

Cancelling 25 once more shows that every value of $\mathcal{B}_{r,0}$, after passage to the target, agrees with B_r modulo $5P_d^+$.

Since

$$(Z_{19}^5 - Z_{19})^2 P_d^+ \subseteq 5P_d^+,$$

the reduction $\bar{Z}_{19}$ satisfies

$$(\bar{Z}_{19}^5 - \bar{Z}_{19})^2 = 0.$$

The factorization

$$(X^5 - X)^2 = \prod_{j \in \mathbf{F}_5} (X - j)^2$$

therefore gives

$$P_d^+ / 5P_d^+ = \bigoplus_{j \in \mathbf{F}_5} \ker(\bar{Z}_{19} - j)^2.$$

On the j -th summand, write $U = \bar{Z}_{19} - j$, so $U^2 = 0$. In characteristic 5,

$$E_\ell(j + U) = (1 - (j - \ell + U)^4)^5 = 1 - (j - \ell)^4 = \begin{cases} 1, & j = \ell, \\ 0, & j \neq \ell. \end{cases}$$

Thus the reductions of $E_\ell(Z_{19})$ are the corresponding orthogonal idempotents. They commute with B_r , since both operators are polynomials in Z_{19} over $\mathbf{Q}_5$.

Fix ℓ , and write E and B for the reductions of $E_\ell(Z_{19})$ and B_r . By the preceding cancellation argument, (6.4) gives

$$P_{r,\ell}(EBE)E = 0.$$

Since B commutes with E , it preserves $\text{im } E$ and $\ker E$. On $\text{im } E$, the operator E is the identity, so this equation gives $P_{r,\ell}(B) = 0$. On $\ker E$, the operator $EP_{r,\ell}(B)$ is zero. Hence $EP_{r,\ell}(B) = 0$ on the whole quotient. Equivalently,

$$E_\ell(Z_{19})P_{r,\ell}(B_r)P_d^+ \subseteq 5P_d^+ \quad (\ell = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4).$$

By saturation, these conclusions restrict to L_d^+ . Together with (6.2), we obtain

$$\begin{aligned} Z_{19}L_d^+ &\subseteq L_d^+, & B_rL_d^+ &\subseteq L_d^+, \\ (T_2^2 - h_{r,0} - h_{r,1}T_{19} - h_{r,2}T_{19}^2)L_d^+ &\subseteq 125L_d^+, \\ E_\ell(Z_{19})P_{r,\ell}(B_r)L_d^+ &\subseteq 5L_d^+ \quad (\ell = 0, 1, 2, 3, 4). \end{aligned} \tag{6.5}$$

6.2 Congruences for a_2 and a_{19}

By the Eichler–Shimura comparison recalled in Section 3.3, choose a primitive simultaneous eigenvector

$$v_f \in L_d^+ \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}_5} \mathcal{O}_f$$

for the prime-to-5 Hecke eigensystem of f . Since Z_{19} and B_r preserve L_d^+ , their eigenvalues

$$z_{19} := \frac{a_{19}(f)}{5}, \quad b_{19} := \frac{N_r(z_{19})}{25}$$

belong to $\mathcal{O}_f$.

Put $c = z_{19}^5 - z_{19}$. We have

$$c(c - 5H_r(z_{19})) = 25b_{19}.$$

Consequently, $c \in 5\mathcal{O}_f$: otherwise $v_5(c) < 1$, so

$$v_5(c - 5H_r(z_{19})) = v_5(c),$$

giving

$$v_5(c(c - 5H_r(z_{19}))) = 2v_5(c) < 2,$$

a contradiction. Thus

$$u_{19} := \frac{z_{19}^5 - z_{19}}{5} \in \mathcal{O}_f, \quad b_{19} = u_{19}^2 - H_r(z_{19})u_{19}.$$

Reducing $z_{19}^5 - z_{19} \in 5\mathcal{O}_f$ modulo the maximal ideal shows that $\bar{z}_{19}$ equals a unique $\ell \in \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4\}$. Since

$$X^5 - X \equiv \prod_{j=0}^4 (X - j) \pmod{5},$$

we have

$$\prod_{j=0}^4 (z_{19} - j) \in 5\mathcal{O}_f.$$

Every factor with $j \neq \ell$ is a unit, so $z_{19} - \ell \in 5\mathcal{O}_f$. Thus

$$z_{19} \equiv_{\text{lit}} \ell \pmod{5}.$$

Evaluating the selector identity in (6.5) on the primitive eigenvector v_f gives

$$E_\ell(z_{19})P_{r,\ell}(b_{19}) \in 5\mathcal{O}_f.$$

Since $z_{19} \equiv_{\text{lit}} \ell \pmod{5}$, we have

$$E_\ell(z_{19}) = (1 - (z_{19} - \ell)^4)^5 \equiv 1 \pmod{5\mathcal{O}_f}.$$

Thus $E_\ell(z_{19})$ is a unit, and $P_{r,\ell}(b_{19}) \in 5\mathcal{O}_f$. Reducing modulo the maximal ideal of $\mathcal{O}_f$ gives

$$\bar{P}_{r,\ell}(\bar{b}_{19}) = 0.$$

Reducing $b_{19} = u_{19}^2 - H_r(z_{19})u_{19}$ also gives

$$\bar{b}_{19} = \bar{u}_{19}^2 - H_r(\ell)\bar{u}_{19}.$$

If $\ell \notin \Lambda_r$, then $\bar{P}_{r,\ell} = 1$, a contradiction. Hence $\ell \in \Lambda_r$.

If $\ell = \bar{v}_r$, then $H_r(\ell) = 2u_r$ and $\bar{P}_{r,\ell}(Y) = (Y + u_r^2)^4$. Thus $(\bar{b}_{19} + u_r^2)^4 = 0$. Since the residue field has no nonzero nilpotents,

$$0 = \bar{b}_{19} + u_r^2 = \bar{u}_{19}^2 - 2u_r\bar{u}_{19} + u_r^2 = (\bar{u}_{19} - u_r)^2,$$

so $\bar{u}_{19} = u_r$.

If $\ell \in \Lambda_r \setminus \{\bar{v}_r\}$, use the identity

$$\prod_{t \in \mathbf{F}_5} (U^2 - aU - t^2 + at) = \prod_{t \in \mathbf{F}_5} (U - t)(U + t - a) = (U^5 - U)^2 \quad (a \in \mathbf{F}_5).$$

Taking $a = H_r(\ell)$, the equality $\bar{P}_{r,\ell}(\bar{b}_{19}) = 0$ therefore gives

$$(\bar{u}_{19}^5 - \bar{u}_{19})^8 = 0.$$

Hence $\bar{u}_{19} \in \mathbf{F}_5$.

Write

$$z_{19} = \ell + 5w_{19}, \quad w_{19} \in \mathcal{O}_f.$$

Then

$$u_{19} = \frac{z_{19}^5 - z_{19}}{5} \equiv \frac{\ell^5 - \ell}{5} - w_{19} \pmod{5\mathcal{O}_f}.$$

Thus $\bar{u}_{19}$ determines $\bar{w}_{19}$, and hence z_{19} modulo 25 in the valuative sense. When $\ell = \bar{v}_r$, the equality $\bar{u}_{19} = u_r$ selects $z_{19} \equiv_{\text{val}} v_r \pmod{25}$. For either of the other two values of ℓ , there are five possibilities, corresponding to $\bar{w}_{19} \in \mathbf{F}_5$.

Consequently,

$$a_{19}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 5t \pmod{125} \quad (6.6)$$

for a unique $t \in \mathbf{Z}/25\mathbf{Z}$ satisfying

$$t = v_r \quad \text{or} \quad \bar{t} \in \{\bar{v}_r + 2, \bar{v}_r - 2\}.$$

There are eleven such values of t for each even residue $r \pmod{100}$.

Evaluating the ordinary joint identity in (6.5) on v_f gives

$$a_2(f)^2 - h_{r,0} - h_{r,1}a_{19}(f) - h_{r,2}a_{19}(f)^2 \in 125\mathcal{O}_f.$$

Together with (6.6), this yields

$$a_2(f)^2 \equiv_{\text{val}} h_{r,0} + 5h_{r,1}t + 25h_{r,2}t^2 \pmod{125}.$$

The constants satisfy

$$h_{r,0} \equiv \begin{cases} 4, & r \equiv 0 \pmod{4}, \\ 1, & r \equiv 2 \pmod{4} \end{cases} \pmod{5}.$$

Thus, for each permitted t , the congruence

$$a^2 \equiv h_{r,0} + 5h_{r,1}t + 25h_{r,2}t^2 \pmod{125}$$

has exactly two roots $a \in \mathbf{Z}/125\mathbf{Z}$, both units. Their reductions modulo 5 are distinct, and one agrees with the reduction of $a_2(f)$. For that root, the factor $a_2(f) + a$ is a unit. Factoring $a_2(f)^2 - a^2$ therefore gives

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a \pmod{125}. \quad (6.7)$$

Consequently, there are 22 permitted pairs $(a, 5t)$ for each even residue $r \pmod{100}$.

6.3 Final classification

By the preceding subsection, every normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform f determines a unique signature

$$\sigma = (r, a, 5t), \quad r \equiv k - 2 \pmod{100}, \quad 0 \leq r < 100,$$

where $(a, 5t)$ is one of the permitted pairs, such that

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a \pmod{125}, \quad a_{19}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 5t \pmod{125}.$$

There are $50 \cdot 22 = 1100$ such signatures altogether.

The finite computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/tree/main/strong_signatures/p5_m3] verifies that every signature is realized by a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform g_σ of weight $k_\sigma \leq 598$, with

$$k_\sigma - 2 \equiv r \pmod{100}.$$

If f has signature σ , then

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_2(g_\sigma) \pmod{125}, \quad a_{19}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_{19}(g_\sigma) \pmod{125}.$$

Moreover, $k_\sigma \equiv k \pmod{100}$, so

$$6^{k_\sigma} \equiv 6^k \pmod{125}.$$

Thus f and g_σ also have the same value of the weight operator $[6]$ modulo 125. By (2.6),

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(5)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_5[T_2, T_{19}, [6]]}.$$

Their prime-to-5 Hecke eigensystems are therefore congruent modulo 125 in the valuative sense:

$$a_n(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_n(g_\sigma) \pmod{125} \quad ((n, 5) = 1).$$

Conversely, suppose that eigenforms f and g , of weights k and K , have congruent prime-to-5 Hecke eigensystems modulo 125. The identities

$$a_2(f)^2 - a_4(f) = 2^{k-1}, \quad a_2(g)^2 - a_4(g) = 2^{K-1}$$

give

$$2^{k-1} \equiv_{\text{val}} 2^{K-1} \pmod{125}.$$

Since these are rational integers, this congruence is literal. As 2 has order 100 modulo 125, we obtain $k \equiv K \pmod{100}$. Agreement at T_2 and T_{19} then implies that their permitted pairs $(a, 5t)$ agree. Thus distinct signatures give distinct eigensystems.

Reducing the signatures modulo 25, direct calculation identifies their values at T_2, T_{19} with those of the Eisenstein twists corresponding to the pairs in Theorem 1.6. For each signature, the pair is unique. Choose $i \geq 3$ and even $\kappa \geq 4$ with

$$\kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{100},$$

and with $\{i, i + \kappa - 1\}$ reducing modulo 20 to the selected pair. By Lemma 2.6 and (2.6), agreement at these generators and at $[6]$ gives

$$\theta^{100} f \equiv_{\text{lit}} \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{25}.$$

By Lemma 2.7,

$$\delta_f := \frac{\theta^{100} f - \theta^i G_\kappa}{25}$$

is a modular form satisfying

$$\theta^{100} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^i G_\kappa + 25\delta_f \pmod{125}.$$

For fixed i, κ , equation (2.6) shows that its q -expansion is determined by the signature and is defined over $\mathbf{F}_5$, since all signature values are rational integers.

Consequently, there are exactly 1100 prime-to-5 Hecke eigensystems modulo 125, in the valuative sense, and every such eigensystem is realized in weight at most 598.

7 The prime 7: classification modulo 49

7.1 Certified Hecke operator identities

Define

$$\begin{aligned} F_0(X) &:= X^6 + 7X^5 + 45X^4 + 7X^3 + 4X^2 + 7X, \\ F_2(X) &:= X^6 + 42X^5 + 6X^4 + 9X^2 + 14X, \\ F_4(X) &:= X^6 + 7X^5 + 47X^4 + 14X^3 + X^2 + 28X. \end{aligned} \tag{7.1}$$

Modulo 7, these factor as

$$\begin{aligned} F_0(X) &\equiv (X(X-3)(X-4))^2, \\ F_2(X) &\equiv (X(X-2)(X-5))^2, \pmod{7}, \\ F_4(X) &\equiv (X(X-1)(X-6))^2 \end{aligned} \quad (7.2)$$

Also put

$$\{\alpha_j, \beta_j\} = \begin{cases} \{3, 4\}, & j = 0, \\ \{2, 5\}, & j = 2, \\ \{1, 6\}, & j = 4, \end{cases} \quad \mathcal{C}_j := \{0, \alpha_j, \beta_j\}.$$

Define

$$Q_j(X) := \frac{F_j(X)}{49}, \quad G_j(X, Y) := \frac{Y - 2 - X(X - \alpha_j)(X - \beta_j)}{7}, \quad j \in \{0, 2, 4\}. \quad (7.3)$$

Finally,

$$H(X) := (X^7 - X)^3.$$

We first treat $Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3)$. The computation is performed at precision $343 = 7^3$. The Dickson multipliers have degrees

$$a_3 = 2058, \quad b_3 = 392, \quad \text{with} \quad a_3 + b_3 = 2450,$$

so the exact induction base consists of the even degrees

$$392 \leq d < 2450.$$

For every such d and every $0 \leq q < 6$, put

$$\mathcal{Q}_q := {}'' \frac{F_{(d+2q) \bmod 6}(t_3)}{49} = \mathfrak{D}_{F_{(d+2q) \bmod 6}(t_3), 49}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/343\mathbf{Z})), \quad \epsilon_q = (-1)^q,$$

where t_3 acts as $\chi_3(3)^q T_3$. The computation [Rus26, https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences/blob/main/playground_mod_49.ipynb] verifies

$$\text{dom } \mathcal{Q}_q = \mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/343\mathbf{Z}), \quad H(\mathcal{Q}_q) \equiv 0 \pmod{7}.$$

These six conditions are closed under both transitions of Remark 3.9: the A_3 -transition preserves $d + 2q \pmod{6}$, while the B_3 -transition sends

$$(d, q) \mapsto (d - 392, q + 1)$$

and again preserves $d + 2q \pmod{6}$.

Now fix an even residue $r \bmod 42$. The preceding transition compatibility and the same strong-induction argument as in Proposition 3.12 propagate these conditions to every degree

$$d \geq 392, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{42}.$$

Applying Proposition 3.11 in orientation $q = 0$, with $m = 3$, $\alpha_1 = 2$, $b = 1$, and $S = 1$, gives

$$Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3) \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_r}(P_d^+), \quad Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3)L_d^+ \subseteq L_d^+.$$

Moreover,

$$H(Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3))P_d^+ \subseteq 7P_d^+, \quad H(Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3))L_d^+ \subseteq 7L_d^+. \quad (7.4)$$

The remaining degrees

$$0 \leq d < 392, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{42},$$

are verified directly. Consequently, these conclusions hold in every even degree

$$d \equiv r \pmod{42}.$$

We next treat $G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29})$. This computation is performed at precision 49. The Dickson multipliers have degrees

$$a_2 = 294, \quad b_2 = 56, \quad \text{with} \quad a_2 + b_2 = 350,$$

so the exact induction base consists of the even degrees

$$56 \leq d < 350.$$

For every such d and every $0 \leq q < 6$, put

$$\mathcal{G}_q := \frac{7G_{(d+2q) \bmod 6}(t_3, t_{29})''}{7} = \mathfrak{D}_{7G_{(d+2q) \bmod 6}(t_3, t_{29}), 7}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/49\mathbf{Z})), \quad \epsilon_q = (-1)^q,$$

where t_n acts as $\chi_2(n)^q T_n$. Here $7G_j$ denotes the integral polynomial

$$7G_j(X, Y) = Y - 2 - X(X - \alpha_j)(X - \beta_j).$$

The computation verifies

$$\text{dom } \mathcal{G}_q = \mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/49\mathbf{Z}), \quad H(\mathcal{G}_q) \equiv 0 \pmod{7}.$$

These six conditions are closed under both transitions of Remark 3.9. Hence the same strong-induction argument as in Proposition 3.12 propagates these conditions to every degree

$$d \geq 56, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{42}.$$

Applying Proposition 3.11 in orientation $q = 0$, with $m = 2$, $\alpha_1 = 1$, $b = 1$, and $S = 1$, gives

$$G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29}) \in \text{End}_{\mathbf{Z}_7}(P_d^+), \quad G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29})L_d^+ \subseteq L_d^+.$$

Moreover,

$$H(G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29}))P_d^+ \subseteq 7P_d^+, \quad H(G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29}))L_d^+ \subseteq 7L_d^+. \quad (7.5)$$

The remaining degrees

$$0 \leq d < 56, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{42},$$

are verified directly. Consequently, these conclusions hold in every even degree

$$d \equiv r \pmod{42}.$$

7.2 Congruences for a_3 and a_{29}

By the Eichler–Shimura comparison recalled in Section 3.3, choose a primitive simultaneous eigenvector

$$v_f \in L_d^+ \otimes_{\mathbf{Z}_7} \mathcal{O}_f$$

for the prime-to-7 Hecke eigensystem of f .

We first determine $a_3(f)$ modulo 7. Since

$$Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3) = \frac{F_{r \bmod 6}(T_3)}{49}$$

is integral on L_d^+ , evaluation on v_f gives

$$F_{r \bmod 6}(a_3(f)) \in 49\mathcal{O}_f.$$

Reducing modulo the maximal ideal and using (7.2), there is a unique

$$c \in \mathcal{C}_{r \bmod 6}$$

such that

$$a_3(f) \equiv c \pmod{\mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}}.$$

Write $a_3(f) = c + y$. Direct calculation gives

$$F_{r \bmod 6}(c) \in 49\mathbf{Z}_7, \quad F'_{r \bmod 6}(c) \in 7\mathbf{Z}_7, \quad \frac{F''_{r \bmod 6}(c)}{2} \in \mathbf{Z}_7^\times.$$

If $0 < v_7(y) < 1$, then in the Taylor expansion of $F_{r \bmod 6}(c + y)$ the quadratic term has strictly smaller valuation than every other term, contradicting

$$F_{r \bmod 6}(a_3(f)) \in 49\mathcal{O}_f.$$

It follows that

$$a_3(f) - c \in 7\mathcal{O}_f. \tag{7.6}$$

Since $G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29})$ is also integral on L_d^+ , evaluation on v_f gives

$$a_{29}(f) - 2 - a_3(f)(a_3(f) - \alpha_{r \bmod 6})(a_3(f) - \beta_{r \bmod 6}) \in 7\mathcal{O}_f.$$

By (7.6), one of the three factors in the cubic product lies in $7\mathcal{O}_f$. Hence

$$a_{29}(f) - 2 \in 7\mathcal{O}_f. \tag{7.7}$$

We may therefore write

$$a_3(f) = c + 7x_f, \quad a_{29}(f) = 2 + 7y_f, \quad x_f, y_f \in \mathcal{O}_f. \tag{7.8}$$

Put

$$q_f := Q_{r \bmod 6}(a_3(f)), \quad g_f := G_{r \bmod 6}(a_3(f), a_{29}(f)).$$

By the preceding subsection,

$$q_f, g_f \in \mathcal{O}_f$$

and

$$H(q_f), H(g_f) \in 7\mathcal{O}_f.$$

Reducing modulo the maximal ideal gives

$$\bar{q}_f^7 = \bar{q}_f, \quad \bar{g}_f^7 = \bar{g}_f,$$

so

$$\bar{q}_f, \bar{g}_f \in \mathbf{F}_7.$$

Plugging

$$a_3 = c + 7x_f, \quad a_{29} = 2 + 7y_f, \quad x_f, y_f \in \mathcal{O}_f,$$

into (7.3) and expanding, we find that

$r \bmod 6$	c	$\bar{q}_f$	$\bar{g}_f$
0	0	$4\bar{x}_f^2 + \bar{x}_f$	$\bar{y}_f - 5\bar{x}_f$
0	3	$2\bar{x}_f^2 + 2\bar{x}_f + 3$	$\bar{y}_f - 4\bar{x}_f$
0	4	$2\bar{x}_f^2$	$\bar{y}_f - 4\bar{x}_f$
2	0	$2\bar{x}_f^2 + 2\bar{x}_f$	$\bar{y}_f - 3\bar{x}_f$
2	2	$\bar{x}_f^2 + 3\bar{x}_f + 4$	$\bar{y}_f - \bar{x}_f$
2	5	$\bar{x}_f^2 + 4\bar{x}_f$	$\bar{y}_f - \bar{x}_f$
4	0	$\bar{x}_f^2 + 4\bar{x}_f$	$\bar{y}_f - 6\bar{x}_f$
4	1	$4\bar{x}_f^2 + \bar{x}_f + 2$	$\bar{y}_f - 2\bar{x}_f$
4	6	$4\bar{x}_f^2 + 2\bar{x}_f + 5$	$\bar{y}_f - 2\bar{x}_f$

(7.9)

Since $\bar{q}_f, \bar{g}_f \in \mathbf{F}_7$, we see that $\bar{x}_f, \bar{y}_f \in \mathbf{F}_{49}$. Thus these relations are already enough to prove the finiteness of the number of away-from-7 Hecke eigensystems in level 1.

In order to obtain classification, we have to correlate $\bar{q}_f$ and $\bar{g}_f$. For $c \in \mathcal{C}_j$, let $E_{j,c}(X) \in \mathbf{Z}[X]$ be the coefficientwise lift, with coefficients in $\{0, \dots, 6\}$, of the Lagrange polynomial

$$\prod_{c' \in \mathcal{C}_j \setminus \{c\}} \frac{X - c'}{c - c'} \in \mathbf{F}_7[X].$$

The denominators are nonzero in $\mathbf{F}_7$, since the elements of $\mathcal{C}_j$ are distinct modulo 7. Thus

$$E_{j,c}(a_3(f)) \equiv \begin{cases} 1 & (\bmod \mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}), \quad a_3(f) \equiv c \pmod{\mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}}, \\ 0 & (\bmod \mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}), \quad a_3(f) \equiv c' \pmod{\mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}} \text{ for some } c' \in \mathcal{C}_j \setminus \{c\}. \end{cases}$$

The classification computation is performed at precision 343. For every even degree

$$392 \leq d < 2450$$

and every orientation $0 \leq q < 6$, put

$$r \equiv d + 14q \pmod{42}.$$

On

$$\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/343\mathbf{Z}), \quad \epsilon_q = (-1)^q,$$

the computation supplies polynomials

$$R_{r,c}^{(1)}, R_{r,c}^{(2)} \in \mathbf{Z}_7[X, Y]$$

for every $c \in \mathcal{C}_{r \bmod 6}$. We use the same notation for their reductions in $\mathbf{F}_7[X, Y]$. On this source module, put

$$\begin{aligned} \mathcal{Q}_q &= " \frac{F_{r \bmod 6}(t_3)}{49} " &:= \mathfrak{D}_{F_{r \bmod 6}(t_3), 49}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/343\mathbf{Z})), \\ \mathcal{G}_q &= " \frac{7G_{r \bmod 6}(t_3, t_{29})}{7} " &:= \mathfrak{D}_{7G_{r \bmod 6}(t_3, t_{29}), 7}(\mathbb{M}_d^{\epsilon_q}(\mathbf{Z}/343\mathbf{Z})), \end{aligned}$$

where t_n acts as $\chi_3(n)^q T_n$. Thus both relations are now taken at precision 343. Let

$$S_{c,q} := E_{r \bmod 6,c}(\chi_3(3)^q T_3)^6.$$

For $\nu \in \{1, 2\}$, the computation verifies

$$[(R_{r,c}^{(\nu)})^3](\mathcal{Q}_q, \mathcal{G}_q)\Gamma_{S_{c,q}} \equiv 0 \pmod{7}.$$

Here the polynomial is cubed and expanded before evaluating it at the linear relations.

These conditions form a periodic family closed under both transitions of Remark 3.9. Indeed, the A_3 -transition preserves r , while the B_3 -transition sends

$$(d, q) \mapsto (d - 392, q + 1)$$

and preserves r modulo 42, since

$$-392 + 14 = -378 \equiv 0 \pmod{42}.$$

Consequently, Proposition 3.12, followed in orientation $q = 0$ by Proposition 3.11 with $m = 3$, division exponents 2, 1, $b = 1$, and $S = E_{r \bmod 6,c}(T_3)^6$, gives, for every even degree $d \geq 392$ with $d \equiv r \pmod{42}$,

$$E_{r \bmod 6,c}(T_3)^6 \left[R_{r,c}^{(\nu)}(Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3), G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29})) \right]^3 L_d^+ \subseteq 7L_d^+.$$

The remaining even degrees $0 \leq d < 392$ are verified directly.

We illustrate the argument on the zero branch $c = 0$ in coefficient-degree residue $r = 0$. Since $E_{0,0}(a_3(f))$ is a unit, it may be cancelled after evaluating the certified operator relations on v_f . After reduction modulo $\mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}$, the resulting joint relations give

$$\bar{q}_f(\bar{q}_f - 3)(\bar{q}_f - 4)(\bar{q}_f - 5) = 0, \quad \bar{g}_f = 2\bar{q}_f.$$

Now using the expressions for $\bar{q}_f$ and $\bar{g}_f$ in terms of $\bar{x}_f$ and $\bar{y}_f$ given in (7.9), we obtain

$$(\bar{x}_f, \bar{y}_f) \in \{(0, 0), (1, 1), (2, 4), (3, 2), (4, 2), (5, 4), (6, 1)\}.$$

In particular, all possible values of $\bar{x}_f$ and $\bar{y}_f$ belong to $\mathbf{F}_7$, even when the residue field of $\mathcal{O}_f$ is larger. Therefore, on this branch,

$$(a_3(f), a_{29}(f)) \equiv_{\text{val}} (7x, 2 + 7y) \pmod{49}$$

for exactly the seven pairs (x, y) listed above.

The computation verifies the analogous calculation for every even residue $r \bmod 42$ with $c = 0$. In each case, the common zero set of the two coordinate relations pulls back under (7.9) to exactly seven pairs

$$(\bar{x}_f, \bar{y}_f) \in \mathbf{F}_7^2.$$

These pairs are enough for exact classification on the zero branch.

For the nonzero branches (i.e. $a_3 \equiv_{\text{lit}} c \pmod{7}$, $c \neq 0$), the relations

$$E_{r \bmod 6, c}(T_3)^6 \left[R_{r, c}^{(\nu)}(Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3), G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29})) \right]^3 L_d^+ \subseteq 7L_d^+$$

still determine the possible pairs $(\bar{q}_f, \bar{g}_f)$, but they do not by themselves determine the correct $(\bar{x}_f, \bar{y}_f)$ corresponding to strong eigenforms. They define a set

$$\mathcal{T}_{r, c} := \left\{ (q, g) \in \mathbf{F}_7^2 : R_{r, c}^{(1)}(q, g) = R_{r, c}^{(2)}(q, g) = 0 \right\}.$$

For every nonzero $c \in \mathcal{C}_{r \bmod 6}$, put formally

$$U_c := \frac{T_3 - c}{7}, \quad V := \frac{T_{29} - 2}{7}.$$

Here division is interpreted through the presented linear relations $\mathfrak{D}_{T, S}$; we do not require U_c or V separately to preserve L_d^+ .

On the same exact induction base and in the same six orientations as above, the computation verifies compatible congruences of presented linear relations, which propagate by Proposition 3.12 to every even degree

$$d \geq 392, \quad d \equiv r \pmod{42},$$

and give

$$E_{r \bmod 6, c}(T_3)^6 \left[E_{r \bmod 6, c}(T_3)^6 U_c - \phi_{r, c}(Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3), G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29})) \right]^3 L_d^+ \subseteq 7L_d^+$$

and

$$E_{r \bmod 6, c}(T_3)^6 \left[E_{r \bmod 6, c}(T_3)^6 V - \psi_{r, c}(Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3), G_{r \bmod 6}(T_3, T_{29})) \right]^3 L_d^+ \subseteq 7L_d^+,$$

for some affine polynomials

$$\phi_{r, c}, \psi_{r, c} \in \mathbf{Z}_7[X, Y].$$

We use the same notation for their reductions in $\mathbf{F}_7[X, Y]$. The remaining even degrees $0 \leq d < 392$ are verified directly.

To justify these lattice inclusions, put $S_c := E_{r \bmod 6, c}(T_3)^6$. For $N = T_3 - c$ or $T_{29} - 2$, the first division equation for the monomial $(S_c N / 7)^3$, starting at $S_c u$, gives

$$S_c^2 N P_d^+ \subseteq 7P_d^+.$$

By the integrality of $Q_{r \bmod 6}(T_3)$ and (7.2), S_c acts on $P_d^+ / 7P_d^+$ invertibly on the generalized c -eigenspace and as zero on the other generalized eigenspaces. Hence $\ker S_c^2 = \ker S_c$, so $S_c N P_d^+ \subseteq 7P_d^+$. Thus $S_c U_c$ and $S_c V$ preserve P_d^+ , and also L_d^+ by saturation. Proposition 3.11, applied with $m = 3$, division exponents 2, 1, 1, $b = 1$, and $S = S_c$, now gives the stated inclusions.

After evaluation on v_f , put $e_f := E_{r \bmod 6, c}(a_3(f))$. Since $e_f \equiv 1 \pmod{\mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}}$, we may cancel the outer unit factor e_f^6 . Reducing modulo $\mathfrak{m}_{\mathcal{O}_f}$, the inner factors e_f^6 also reduce to 1, giving

$$\bar{x}_f = \phi_{r, c}(\bar{q}_f, \bar{g}_f), \quad \bar{y}_f = \psi_{r, c}(\bar{q}_f, \bar{g}_f).$$

Thus every point of $\mathcal{T}_{r, c}$ determines exactly one permitted pair $(\bar{x}_f, \bar{y}_f)$.

For example, take $r = 40$ and $c = 1$. The coordinate relations give

$$\mathcal{T}_{40,1} = \{(0, 1), (2, 0), (2, 3), (6, 6)\}.$$

The corresponding graph relations reduce to

$$\bar{x}_f = 3\bar{g}_f + 5, \quad \bar{y}_f = 3.$$

Evaluating these formulas on the four points of $\mathcal{T}_{40,1}$ gives

$$(\bar{x}_f, \bar{y}_f) \in \{(0, 3), (1, 3), (2, 3), (5, 3)\}.$$

Consequently, on this branch,

$$(a_3(f), a_{29}(f)) \equiv_{\text{val}} (1 + 7x, 2 + 7y) \pmod{49}$$

for precisely these four pairs (x, y) .

The other nonzero branch is treated in the same way. In every coefficient-degree residue, the centre-zero branch contributes seven signatures and each of the two nonzero branches contributes four, giving fifteen signatures in total. All of these signatures have coordinates in $\mathbf{Z}/49\mathbf{Z}$.

7.3 Final classification

Proof of Theorem 1.7. By the preceding subsections, every normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform f determines a unique signature

$$\sigma = (r, c, x, y), \quad r \equiv k - 2 \pmod{42}, \quad c \in \mathcal{C}_{r \bmod 6}, \quad x, y \in \mathbf{Z}/7\mathbf{Z},$$

such that

$$a_3(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} c + 7x \pmod{49}, \quad a_{29}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 2 + 7y \pmod{49}.$$

For each residue $r \bmod 42$, there are exactly 15 such signatures, and hence 315 signatures altogether.

The finite computation verifies that every one of these 315 signatures is realized by a normalized cuspidal level-one eigenform g_σ of weight $k_\sigma \leq 380$, with

$$k_\sigma - 2 \equiv r \pmod{42}.$$

If f has signature σ , then

$$a_3(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_3(g_\sigma) \pmod{49}, \quad a_{29}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_{29}(g_\sigma) \pmod{49},$$

and

$$k_\sigma \equiv k \pmod{42}.$$

Since 3 has order 42 modulo 49, the latter congruence gives

$$3^{k_\sigma} \equiv 3^k \pmod{49},$$

so f and g_σ also have the same value of the weight operator $[3]$ modulo 49.

By Section 2.2.3,

$$\mathbb{T}_{\text{dc}}^{(7)} = \overline{\mathbf{Z}_7[T_3, T_{29}, [3]]}.$$

Hence the prime-to-7 Hecke eigensystems of f and g_σ are congruent modulo 49 in the valuative sense. Therefore

$$a_n(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} a_n(g_\sigma) \pmod{49} \quad ((n, 7) = 1).$$

Consequently, only finitely many prime-to-7 Hecke eigensystems occur modulo 49, and every such eigensystem is realized in weight at most 380. In fact, the argument gives exactly 315 eigensystems.

Reducing the signatures modulo 7, direct calculation identifies their values at T_3, T_{29} with those of the Eisenstein twists corresponding to the pairs in Theorem 1.7. For each signature, the pair $\{a, b\}$ is unique. Choose $i \geq 2$ and even $\kappa \geq 4$ with

$$\{i, i + \kappa - 1\} = \{a, b\} \quad \text{in } \mathbf{Z}/6\mathbf{Z}, \quad \kappa + 2i \equiv k \pmod{42}.$$

By Lemma 2.6 and the completed-Hecke generation above, agreement at T_3, T_{29} and [3] gives

$$\theta^{42} f \equiv_{\text{lit}} \theta^i G_\kappa \pmod{7}.$$

By Lemma 2.7,

$$\delta_f := \frac{\theta^{42} f - \theta^i G_\kappa}{7}$$

is a modular form satisfying

$$\theta^{42} f \equiv_{\text{val}} \theta^i G_\kappa + 7\delta_f \pmod{49}.$$

For fixed i, κ , completed-Hecke generation shows that its q -expansion is determined by the signature and is defined over $\mathbf{F}_7$, since all signature values are rational integers. The reductions of the 315 signatures cover all nine listed pairs, so their strong realizations also realize every listed Eisenstein twist modulo 7. This proves Theorem 1.7. $\square$

Part III

Applications

8 Strong prime-to- p weight bounds

Throughout this section, congruences are understood in the valuative sense.

In [KRW16, §1.5], the finiteness conjecture for strong eigenforms modulo p^m is reformulated in terms of a strong weight bound: for fixed N, p, m , one asks for a constant $B(N, p, m)$ such that every strong eigenform of level N is congruent modulo p^m to a strong eigenform of the same level and of weight at most $B(N, p, m)$.

The classifications proved above concern only the prime-to- p Hecke eigensystem. We therefore introduce the corresponding prime-to- p notion. A number B is called a *strong prime-to- p weight bound* for (N, p, m) if every normalized characteristic-zero cuspidal eigenform f of level N is congruent modulo p^m , at all Hecke operators prime to p , to a normalized

characteristic-zero cuspidal eigenform g of level N and weight at most B . We denote the least such bound, when it exists, by

$$B^{(p)}(N, p, m).$$

It is also natural to allow cyclotomic twists. A number B is called a *strong weight bound up to θ -twist* for (N, p, m) if, for every normalized characteristic-zero cuspidal eigenform f of level N , there exist an integer $i \geq 0$ and a normalized characteristic-zero cuspidal eigenform g of level N and weight at most B such that

$$a_n(f) \equiv n^i a_n(g) \pmod{p^m} \quad ((n, p) = 1).$$

We denote the least such bound, when it exists, by

$$B_\theta(N, p, m).$$

Equivalently, the prime-to- p eigensystem of f is congruent modulo p^m to the θ^i -twist of that of g .

modulus	strong weight bound B	bound up to θ -twist B_θ
2	12	12
2^2	12	12
2^3	12	12
2^4	18	12
2^5	22	16
2^6	30	24
2^7	46	32
2^8	90	62
2^9	158 [†]	128 [†]
3	12	12
3^2	32	16
3^3	70	24
3^4	214	58
3^5	646 [†]	166 [†]
5	30	12
5^2	142	24
5^3	598	106
7	56	16
7^2	380	78

Table 2: Strong level-one weight bounds for prime-power away-from- p congruences. The bound B_θ means that every strong eigensystem is congruent away from p to $\theta^i g$ for some $i \geq 0$ and some strong level-one eigenform g of weight at most B_θ . The entries marked [†] are conjectural.

The proved and conjectural values in Table 2 display some suggestive patterns. For $p = 3, 5, 7$, the proved values at $m = 1, 2$ satisfy

$$B^{(p)}(1, p, m) = (p + 2)\varphi(p^m) + 2.$$

At the higher exponents, a different uniform pattern appears: the values for

$$(p, m) = (3, 3), (3, 4), (3, 5), (5, 3)$$

satisfy

$$B^{(p)}(1, p, m) = (p + 1)\varphi(p^m) - 2.$$

The data for $p = 2$ appear less regular, although the bounds remain of the same order of magnitude as $\varphi(2^m)$. The bounds up to θ -twist likewise do not yet suggest a uniform formula valid for all primes and exponents. It seems premature to conjecture an exact general formula from these data, though it seems more reasonable to ask the following.

Question. Does there exist, for every prime p , a constant $C_p > 0$ such that

$$B^{(p)}(1, p, m) \leq C_p \varphi(p^m)$$

for every $m \geq 1$?

A Signatures modulo 81

For each even weight residue $k \bmod 54$, the permitted signatures are listed below. The entries α, β represent the congruences

$$a_2(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} \alpha \pmod{81}, \quad a_7(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} \beta \pmod{81}.$$

Choose $\omega \in \overline{\mathbb{Z}}_3$ with $\omega^2 = 2$, and put

$$\mathcal{E} := \{0, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 9 \pm 27\omega, 72 \pm 27\omega\}.$$

Both signs are included, so $\mathcal{E}$ contains eleven values. In every row, $\beta \equiv 1 + 7^{k-1} \pmod{81}$.

Table 3: The 159 permitted signatures modulo 81.

$k \bmod 54$	Permitted values α	β
0	12, 39, 42, 69	59
2	3, 24, 57, 78	8
4	0, 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72	20
6	6, 33, 48, 75	41
8	6, 33, 48, 75	17
10	$\mathcal{E}$	56
12	3, 24, 57, 78	23
14	12, 39, 42, 69	26
16	0, 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72	11
18	15, 39, 42, 66	5
20	24, 30, 51, 57	35
22	0, 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72	47
24	6, 21, 60, 75	68
26	21, 33, 48, 60	44
28	$\mathcal{E}$	2
30	3, 30, 51, 78	50
32	12, 15, 66, 69	53
34	0, 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72	38
36	12, 15, 66, 69	32
38	3, 30, 51, 78	62
40	0, 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72	74
42	21, 33, 48, 60	14
44	6, 21, 60, 75	71
46	$\mathcal{E}$	29
48	24, 30, 51, 57	77
50	15, 39, 42, 66	80
52	0, 9, 18, 27, 36, 45, 54, 63, 72	65

B Signatures modulo 49

For each even weight residue $k \bmod 42$, the permitted signatures are listed below. The entries c, x, y are taken in $\{0, \dots, 6\}$, and represent the congruences

$$a_3(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} c + 7x \pmod{49}, \quad a_{29}(f) \equiv_{\text{val}} 2 + 7y \pmod{49}.$$

Table 4: The 315 permitted signatures modulo 49.

$k \bmod 42$	c	Permitted pairs (x, y)
0	0	$\{(0, 6), (1, 1), (2, 0), (3, 3), (4, 3), (5, 0), (6, 1)\}$
	1	$\{(0, 3), (1, 3), (2, 3), (5, 3)\}$
	6	$\{(1, 3), (4, 3), (5, 3), (6, 3)\}$
2	0	$\{(0, 0), (1, 1), (2, 4), (3, 2), (4, 2), (5, 4), (6, 1)\}$
	3	$\{(0, 4), (1, 4), (3, 4), (6, 4)\}$
	4	$\{(0, 4), (3, 4), (5, 4), (6, 4)\}$
4	0	$\{(0, 4), (1, 1), (2, 6), (3, 5), (4, 5), (5, 6), (6, 1)\}$
	2	$\{(0, 5), (3, 5), (5, 5), (6, 5)\}$
	5	$\{(0, 5), (1, 5), (3, 5), (6, 5)\}$
6	0	$\{(0, 4), (1, 6), (2, 5), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 5), (6, 6)\}$
	1	$\{(0, 6), (1, 6), (4, 6), (6, 6)\}$
	6	$\{(0, 6), (2, 6), (5, 6), (6, 6)\}$
8	0	$\{(0, 0), (1, 1), (2, 4), (3, 2), (4, 2), (5, 4), (6, 1)\}$
	3	$\{(0, 0), (2, 0), (5, 0), (6, 0)\}$
	4	$\{(0, 0), (1, 0), (4, 0), (6, 0)\}$
10	0	$\{(0, 6), (1, 3), (2, 1), (3, 0), (4, 0), (5, 1), (6, 3)\}$
	2	$\{(1, 1), (2, 1), (3, 1), (6, 1)\}$
	5	$\{(0, 1), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 1)\}$
12	0	$\{(0, 1), (1, 3), (2, 2), (3, 5), (4, 5), (5, 2), (6, 3)\}$
	1	$\{(0, 2), (1, 2), (2, 2), (5, 2)\}$
	6	$\{(1, 2), (4, 2), (5, 2), (6, 2)\}$
14	0	$\{(0, 6), (1, 0), (2, 3), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 3), (6, 0)\}$
	3	$\{(0, 3), (3, 3), (4, 3), (5, 3)\}$
	4	$\{(1, 3), (2, 3), (3, 3), (6, 3)\}$
16	0	$\{(0, 0), (1, 4), (2, 2), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 2), (6, 4)\}$
	2	$\{(1, 4), (2, 4), (3, 4), (6, 4)\}$
	5	$\{(0, 4), (3, 4), (4, 4), (5, 4)\}$
18	0	$\{(0, 4), (1, 6), (2, 5), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 5), (6, 6)\}$
	1	$\{(1, 5), (3, 5), (4, 5), (5, 5)\}$
	6	$\{(1, 5), (2, 5), (3, 5), (5, 5)\}$
20	0	$\{(0, 4), (1, 5), (2, 1), (3, 6), (4, 6), (5, 1), (6, 5)\}$
	3	$\{(0, 6), (1, 6), (2, 6), (4, 6)\}$
	4	$\{(2, 6), (4, 6), (5, 6), (6, 6)\}$

Continued on the next page

Table 4 (continued)

$k \bmod 42$	c	Permitted pairs (x, y)
22	0	$\{(0, 0), (1, 4), (2, 2), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 2), (6, 4)\}$
	2	$\{(0, 0), (3, 0), (5, 0), (6, 0)\}$
	5	$\{(0, 0), (1, 0), (3, 0), (6, 0)\}$
24	0	$\{(0, 6), (1, 1), (2, 0), (3, 3), (4, 3), (5, 0), (6, 1)\}$
	1	$\{(1, 1), (2, 1), (3, 1), (6, 1)\}$
	6	$\{(0, 1), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 1)\}$
26	0	$\{(0, 1), (1, 2), (2, 5), (3, 3), (4, 3), (5, 5), (6, 2)\}$
	3	$\{(0, 2), (3, 2), (4, 2), (5, 2)\}$
	4	$\{(1, 2), (2, 2), (3, 2), (6, 2)\}$
28	0	$\{(0, 6), (1, 3), (2, 1), (3, 0), (4, 0), (5, 1), (6, 3)\}$
	2	$\{(0, 3), (1, 3), (4, 3), (6, 3)\}$
	5	$\{(0, 3), (2, 3), (5, 3), (6, 3)\}$
30	0	$\{(0, 0), (1, 2), (2, 1), (3, 4), (4, 4), (5, 1), (6, 2)\}$
	1	$\{(1, 4), (2, 4), (3, 4), (6, 4)\}$
	6	$\{(0, 4), (3, 4), (4, 4), (5, 4)\}$
32	0	$\{(0, 4), (1, 5), (2, 1), (3, 6), (4, 6), (5, 1), (6, 5)\}$
	3	$\{(0, 5), (2, 5), (5, 5), (6, 5)\}$
	4	$\{(0, 5), (1, 5), (4, 5), (6, 5)\}$
34	0	$\{(0, 4), (1, 1), (2, 6), (3, 5), (4, 5), (5, 6), (6, 1)\}$
	2	$\{(2, 6), (4, 6), (5, 6), (6, 6)\}$
	5	$\{(0, 6), (1, 6), (2, 6), (4, 6)\}$
36	0	$\{(0, 0), (1, 2), (2, 1), (3, 4), (4, 4), (5, 1), (6, 2)\}$
	1	$\{(1, 0), (3, 0), (4, 0), (5, 0)\}$
	6	$\{(1, 0), (2, 0), (3, 0), (5, 0)\}$
38	0	$\{(0, 6), (1, 0), (2, 3), (3, 1), (4, 1), (5, 3), (6, 0)\}$
	3	$\{(0, 1), (1, 1), (3, 1), (6, 1)\}$
	4	$\{(0, 1), (3, 1), (5, 1), (6, 1)\}$
40	0	$\{(0, 1), (1, 5), (2, 3), (3, 2), (4, 2), (5, 3), (6, 5)\}$
	2	$\{(0, 2), (1, 2), (4, 2), (6, 2)\}$
	5	$\{(0, 2), (2, 2), (5, 2), (6, 2)\}$

References

- [Are61] R. Arens, *Operational calculus of linear relations*, Pacific J. Math. **11** (1961), no. 1, 9–23, <https://doi.org/10.2140/pjm.1961.11.9>.
- [BK15] J. Bellaïche and C. Khare, *Level 1 Hecke algebras of modular forms modulo p* , Compos. Math. **151** (2015), no. 3, 397–415, <https://doi.org/10.1112/S0010437X1400774X>.
- [CE04] F. Calegari and M. Emerton, *The Hecke algebra T_k has large index*, Math. Res. Lett. **11** (2004), no. 1, 125–137, <https://doi.org/10.4310/MRL.2004.v11.n1.a12>.
- [CKW13] I. Chen, I. Kiming, and G. Wiese, *On modular Galois representations modulo prime powers*, International Journal of Number Theory **9** (2013), no. 1, 91–113, <https://arxiv.org/abs/1105.1918>.
- [CS04] R. F. Coleman and W. A. Stein, *Approximation of eigenforms of infinite slope by eigenforms of finite slope*, in *Geometric Aspects of Dwork Theory*, vol. I, de Gruyter, 2004, 437–449, especially §3.2, Conjecture 3.4, pp. 443–444, https://wstein.org/papers/padictwist/padictwist_v15.pdf.
- [Den23] T. Deng, *Torsions in cohomology of $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbf{Z})$ and congruence of modular forms*, J. Number Theory **246** (2023), 87–156, <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jnt.2022.11.013>.
- [Hat77a] K. Hatada, *On the divisibility by 2 of the eigenvalues of Hecke operators*, Proc. Japan Acad. Ser. A Math. Sci. **53** (1977), no. 1, 37–40.
- [Hat77b] K. Hatada, *Congruences of the eigenvalues of Hecke operators*, Proc. Japan Acad. Ser. A Math. Sci. **53** (1977), no. 4, 125–128.
- [Hat79] K. Hatada, *Eigenvalues of Hecke operators on $\mathrm{SL}(2, \mathbf{Z})$* , Math. Ann. **239** (1979), no. 1, 75–96, especially the Theorem, congruence (5), p. 75, <https://doi.org/10.1007/BF01420494>.
- [Hat81] K. Hatada, *Congruences for eigenvalues of Hecke operators on $\mathrm{SL}_2(\mathbf{Z})$* , Manuscripta Math. **34** (1981), 305–326.
- [Joc82] N. Jochnowitz, *Congruences between systems of eigenvalues of modular forms*, Trans. Amer. Math. Soc. **270** (1982), no. 1, 269–285, <https://doi.org/10.1090/S0002-9947-1982-0642341-2>.
- [Kat75a] N. M. Katz, *Higher congruences between modular forms*, Ann. of Math. (2) **101** (1975), no. 2, 332–367.
- [Kat75b] N. M. Katz, *p -adic L -functions via moduli of elliptic curves*, in *Algebraic Geometry (Arcata, 1974)*, Proc. Sympos. Pure Math. **29**, Amer. Math. Soc., 1975, 479–506.
- [KRW16] I. Kiming, N. Rustom, and G. Wiese, *On certain finiteness questions in the arithmetic of modular forms*, J. Lond. Math. Soc. (2) **94** (2016), no. 2, 479–502, <https://doi.org/10.1112/jlms/jdw045>.
- [Med15] A. Medvedovsky, *Lower bounds on dimensions of mod- p Hecke algebras: the nilpotence method*, Ph.D. thesis, Brandeis University, 2015; updated manuscript dated May 6, 2016, <https://people.mpim-bonn.mpg.de/medved/Mathwriting/MedvedovskyDissertation.pdf>.

- [Mer94] L. Merel, *Universal Fourier expansions of modular forms*, in *On Artin's Conjecture for Odd 2-Dimensional Representations*, Lecture Notes in Math. 1585, Springer, 1994, 59–94, especially Theorems 2, 3, and 4 and Propositions 5, 6, 10, 11, and 20, <https://doi.org/10.1007/BFb0074110>.
- [Pre09] M. Prest, *Purity, Spectra and Localisation*, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 2009, <https://doi.org/10.1017/CB09781139644242>.
- [Rus19] N. Rustom, *Congruences modulo prime powers of Hecke eigenvalues in level 1*, Res. Number Theory **5** (2019), article 10, 27 pp., <https://doi.org/10.1007/s40993-018-0147-5>.
- [Rus26] N. Rustom, *Hecke congruences: computational software and data*, GitHub repository, 2026, <https://github.com/nrustom/hecke-congruences>.
- [Ser73] J.-P. Serre, *Formes modulaires et fonctions zêta p -adiques*, in *Modular Functions of One Variable III*, Lecture Notes in Math. 350, Springer, 1973, 191–268.
- [Ste87] R. Steinberg, *On Dickson's theorem on invariants*, J. Fac. Sci. Univ. Tokyo Sect. IA Math. **34** (1987), no. 3, 699–707.
- [Wie09] G. Wiese, *On modular symbols and the cohomology of Hecke triangle surfaces*, Int. J. Number Theory **5** (2009), no. 1, 89–108, <https://doi.org/10.1142/S1793042109001967>.